

Visit guidance

Version 16.0

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About this guidance

This guidance tells you about applications for Entry Clearance, permission to enter and permission to stay in the UK on the visitor route.

Contacts

If you have any questions about the guidance and your line manager or senior caseworker cannot help you or you think that the guidance has factual errors then email Visitor Route Policy.

If you notice any formatting errors in this guidance (broken links, spelling mistakes and so on) or have any comments about the layout or navigability of the guidance then you can email the email the Guidance Review, Atlas and Forms team.

Publication

Below is information on when this version of the guidance was published:

- version **16.0**
- published for Home Office staff on **11 November 2025**

Changes from last version of this guidance

- updated changes to reflect change on replacing Part 9: Grounds for refusal to Part Suitability

Related content

[Contents](#)

Quick guide: visit visa

This section is a quick reference guide to the process for making a decision on visit visa applications lodged outside the UK. This does not apply in respect of applications for Transit visit visas (see: Transit guidance) but note that Standard and Marriage / Civil Partnership visitors can transit the UK.

When considering a visit visa application, you need to consider:

- if the applicant meets the [validity requirements](#)
- all the mandatory identity checks
- if the applicant falls to be refused under [suitability](#) grounds of Part Suitability – see Part Suitability guidance - Grounds for refusal and cancellation (suitability) for more information
- is a [third party providing support](#) - do they have a genuine relationship- is the third party in the UK in breach of immigration laws - can and will the third party provide support for the duration of the applicant's stay
- if there are additional eligibility requirements for their type or purpose of visit, does the applicant meet them, see:
 - [children](#) (Complex - if unaccompanied)
 - [Approved Destination Status \(ADS\)](#)
 - [private medical treatment](#) (Complex)
 - [organ donor](#) (Complex)
 - [study \(for up to 6 months\)](#)
 - [academics \(more than 6 months\)](#) (Complex regardless of duration)
 - [work related training](#)
 - [marriage and civil partnership](#) (Complex)
 - [permitted paid engagements \(PPE\)](#) (Complex)
- is the visitor intending to undertake activities for which they are required to provide specific supporting documents, for example:
 - private medical treatment (Complex)
 - Professional and Linguistic Assessment Board (PLAB) Test and Objective Structured Clinical Examination (OSCE)
 - [permitted paid engagements](#) (PPE) (Complex)
- do you need to make a [referral](#), for example:
 - is there a mandatory referral requirement (Complex)
 - if the applicant fails to meet the Visitor rules, but there are genuinely exceptional or compelling circumstances to consider leave outside the rules – see guidance on Leave outside the Immigration Rules for more information
- what [duration of visa to grant](#), for example:
 - is there a specific duration of grant (ADS, private medical, academic)
 - have they applied for a [multiple entry long term visit visa](#)
 - is there reason to grant a [short duration](#) or [single entry visa](#)
- having considered the above do you assess that the applicant is a [genuine visitor](#) – that is, are you satisfied that they:
 - intend only to undertake [permitted activities](#) and to [leave](#) at the end of their stay
 - will [not be living in the UK or making the UK their home through frequent and successive visits](#)

- will not be doing any [prohibited activities](#)
- have sufficient [funds, maintenance and accommodation](#) for duration of stay
- have you completed all the relevant [recording requirements](#)?

Visa decision making complex and non-complex cases

Visa, Status & Information Services operate a workflow routing tool (Complexity Application Routing Solution) which all Decision - making Centres (DMCs) must follow.

This is set out in the revised interim workflow routing solution for visitor applications process guidance: [Complexity application routing solution \(visits\): caseworker guidance](#)

This process is to be used when routing and assessing applications from those customers who are applying from overseas as a visitor under the relevant Immigration Rules. The process guidance should be read in conjunction with this guidance about the visitor route.

Applications will be allocated to decision makers based on complexity, which is determined by applying various person-centric (applicant specific) attributes. Some endorsement types are excluded from the attribute process as they involve greater complexity due to additional requirements of the rules which need a more detailed assessment, and these are marked with a complex indicator in the [Quick guide](#).

Where the attributes supporting a non-complex routing outcome have been demonstrated, normally by validating the statements made in the application by checking the supporting evidence or information provided, a decision maker may be satisfied under the balance of probabilities that the requirements of the Visitor rules are met. This would, amongst other factors, ordinarily enable a decision-maker to assess an application more quickly.

In addition to the above, you must also identify as complex any application where:

- no additional evidence, or information, other than the application form is presented with the application
- you are unable to assess the application in full because, while some evidence has been submitted to enable a consideration to take place, some information is missing
- the application includes evidence which, following consideration, indicates irregularities, and you consider that further analysis or checks are required to confirm the veracity of the evidence
- a previous application has been refused on suitability grounds (Part Suitability)
- you have any other doubts about the evidence presented
- you have any concerns about modern slavery
- you have any other reason for thinking that the requirements of the rules might not be met

You should then follow the [Quick guide](#). The positive attributes and the absence of any negative indicators should mean relevant factors are more readily apparent enabling you to assess a non-complex application rapidly.

Visa endorsement codes

For further information on visa endorsement codes see: [Visit endorsement guidance](#).

People who are British citizens or who have right of abode

A person who is a British citizen, or who has right of abode in the UK cannot be given permission to enter or stay under the Immigration Rules. This is because under [section 1\(1\) of the Immigration Act 1971](#) a person with right of abode is not subject to immigration control.

If a person who has right of abode applies for a visit visa and you are satisfied that they have right of abode, you should advise them that their application cannot be considered, the application will be withdrawn, and they may want to apply for a certificate of entitlement to right of abode or a British passport instead.

If you believe the person may have right of abode in the UK, but they have applied for a certificate of entitlement to right of abode or a British passport and have been refused on the basis that they have not established their entitlement, you can issue a visit visa provided the applicant meets the Immigration Rules. Where you are not satisfied that they meet the Visitor rules, they can be refused a visa in line with the rules (for example: that they are not a genuine visitor).

Irish citizens

The Common Travel Area (CTA) is a long-standing arrangement between the UK, the Crown Dependencies (Bailiwick of Jersey, Bailiwick of Guernsey and the Isle of Man) and Ireland.

Under the CTA, British and Irish citizens can move freely and reside in either jurisdiction. British and Irish citizens enjoy associated reciprocal rights and privileges, including the right to work, study and vote in certain elections, as well as to access social welfare benefits and health services in each other's countries.

After Free Movement ended on 1 January 2021, Irish citizens' status continues to be protected. This is provided for under section 3ZA of the Immigration Act 1971, which means that they do not require permission to enter or stay in the UK for any reason including to visit, except for in a limited number of circumstances.

An Irish Citizen will need permission to enter or stay if they are subject to any of the following:

- a deportation order made under section 5(1) of the Immigration Act 1971
- an exclusion decision, or an exclusion order made under regulation 23(5) of the Immigration (European Economic Area) Regulations 2016

- a travel ban implemented under section 8B of the Immigration Act 1971

Those who fall within one of the exemptions above do require permission to enter or stay. You should therefore consider their application in line with the relevant Immigration Rules in the same way as any other applicant, noting that Part Suitability [immigration rules](#) may apply.

If you are unsure about how you should proceed with an application from an Irish citizen, then please contact the CTA Policy Team for further information.

Related content

[Contents](#)

Related external links

[ECB22: extant leave](#)

[ECB05: where to apply](#)

Quick guide: visitors at the border

This section is a quick reference guide to the process for making a decision on an application for entry at the UK border as a visitor. Please see separate Transit guidance on visitors transiting the UK, but note that Standard and Marriage / Civil Partnership visitors can transit the UK. Please see separate guidance on the Common Travel Area for visitors arriving in the UK via Ireland.

When considering an application for entry as a visitor at the border, you need to consider:

- all the mandatory checks at the border
- if the applicant has a visa or existing permission to enter or stay, [do they meet any of the grounds for cancellation](#) under Part Suitability Grounds for refusal and cancellation (suitability) guidance
- if the applicant is a child with a visa endorsed as [accompanied, are they with the specified adult or adults](#)
- if the applicant does not have a visa or existing permission to enter or stay, do they need a visit visa in advance, are they:
 - a visa national not on the exceptions list
 - an academic, academic dependant, visitor for private medical treatment coming for more than 6 months
 - a visitor for marriage or civil partnership, unless they are [changing an existing civil partnership to a marriage](#)
- if the applicant is a non-visa national, are they a [genuine visitor](#), that is:
 - do they intend only to undertake [permitted activities](#) and [leave](#) at the end of their stay
 - are you satisfied they will [not be living in the UK or making the UK their home through frequent and successive visits](#)
 - will they be doing any [prohibited activities](#)
 - do they have sufficient [funds, maintenance and accommodation](#) for the duration of their stay
 - is a [third party providing support](#) - do they have a genuine relationship - is the third party in the UK in breach of immigration laws – can and will the third party provide support for the duration of the applicants stay
- are there additional eligibility requirements for the route or purpose of visit, see:
 - [children](#)
 - [private medical treatment](#)
 - [organ donor](#)
 - [study \(for up to 6 months\)](#)
 - [work related training](#)
 - [marriage and civil partnership](#)
 - [permitted paid engagements \(PPE\)](#)
- is the visitor intending to undertake activities for which they are required to provide specific supporting documents, for example
 - private medical treatment
 - Professional and Linguistic Assessment Board (PLAB)
 - Test and Objective Structured Clinical Examination (OSCE)

- [permitted paid engagements \(PPE\)](#)
- have you completed all the relevant [recording requirements](#), – noting the process for [EEA, Swiss and B5JSSK nationals](#)

Permission to enter endorsement codes

For further information on permission to enter endorsement codes see: [Visit endorsement guidance](#).

On - entry refusal codes at the border

The on-entry refusal codes at border are:

- A1 - insufficient funds for proposed visit
- A2 - not satisfied genuine visitor
- A4 - unsatisfactory or unacceptable arrangements for proposed study
- E4 - lack of required visa or entry clearance

Irish citizens

Irish citizens are not eligible to apply for permission (leave) to enter or stay under the Visitor rules, except where they are subject to any of the following:

- a deportation order made under section 5(1) of the Immigration Act 1971
- an exclusion decision, or an exclusion order made under regulation 23(5) of the Immigration (European Economic Area) Regulations 2016
- a travel ban implemented under section 8B of the Immigration Act 1971

If an Irish citizen applies for permission under the Visitor rules at the border, they cannot be granted that permission unless they fall under one of the above exceptions but instead will be allowed to enter on the basis of proof of their status as an Irish Citizen. If they fall under one of the above exceptions, then they require permission and should be considered in the same way as any other passenger, noting that Part Suitability [Immigration Rules](#) may apply.

If you are unsure about how you should proceed with an application from an Irish citizen then please contact the CTA Policy Team for further information.

EEA, Swiss and B5JSSK nationals

Nationals of Australia, Canada, Japan, New Zealand, Singapore, South Korea, the United States of America (B5JSSK), EEA states and Switzerland can use ePassport gates to enter the UK. If they do so without holding a valid entry clearance they will automatically receive 6 months permission to enter as a Standard visitor and will not receive an endorsement in their passport.

If granting permission to enter as a Standard visitor to a B5JSSK, EEA or Swiss national at the staffed primary control point, you should not endorse the passenger's

travel document with a code 5N stamp but should instead grant permission to enter verbally, in line with the guidance on ePassport gate eligible nationalities.

Related content

[Contents](#)

Quick guide: permission to stay as a visitor

This section is a quick reference guide to the process for making a decision on an application to extend stay in the UK as a visitor.

When assessing an application you should consider:

- if the applicant meets the [validity requirements](#)
- all the mandatory identity checks
- can the applicant extend – paragraph V 15.1 – V 15.4 of [Appendix V: Visitor](#)
- the suitability requirements under Part Suitability [Immigration Rules - Guidance](#)
- is the applicant a [genuine visitor](#) and:
 - do they intend to undertake only [permitted activities](#) and [leave](#) at the end of their stay
 - are you satisfied they will [not be living in the UK or making the UK their home through frequent and successive visits](#)
 - will they be doing any [prohibited activities](#)
 - do they have sufficient [funds, maintenance and accommodation](#) for the duration of their stay
 - is a [third party providing support](#) - do they have a genuine relationship - is the third party in the UK in breach of immigration laws – can and will the third party provide support for the duration of the applicant's stay
- does the applicant meet the additional eligibility requirements for their permission to stay:
 - for private medical treatment
 - as an academic
 - as a visitor doing a PLAB test and clinical attachments
- have you completed all the relevant [recording requirements](#)

Permission to stay endorsement codes

For further information on permission to stay endorsement codes see: Visit endorsement guidance.

Irish citizens

As set out [above](#), Irish citizens are not eligible to apply for permission (leave) to enter or stay under the Visitor rules, except where they are subject to any of the following:

- a deportation order made under section 5(1) of the Immigration Act 1971
- an exclusion decision, or an exclusion order made under regulation 23(5) of the Immigration (European Economic Area) Regulations 2016
- a travel ban implemented under section 8B of the Immigration Act 1971

If an Irish citizen falls within one of the above exceptions, 3ZA of the Immigration Act 1971 states that they require permission to enter or stay. They may have been granted permission as a visitor and may therefore be eligible to make an extension application under the Visitor rules in country. You should consider their application in line with the Visitor rules in the same way as any other applicant.

Related content

[Contents](#)

Related external links

[FLR\(IR\) for extensions](#)

Visit: validity requirements for applications for visit visas and permission to stay as a visitor

This section tells caseworkers how to consider whether the validity requirements are met for applications for entry clearance or permission to stay as a Visitor.

See: paragraphs V 2.1 to V 2.6 of [Appendix V: Visitor](#).

The validity requirements do not apply to those seeking permission to enter at the border.

Before considering any application, you must check that the application is valid by referring to the validity requirements for the Visitor route: the applicant must have applied on the specified form; paid any fees required; provided any required biometrics; provided a valid passport or other identity document.

An application for a visit visa must also be made while the applicant is outside the UK and to a post designated to accept visit visa applications.

An applicant for permission to stay must also be in the UK and have permission as a Standard visitor or Marriage / Civil Partnership visitor.

For guidance on how to consider the validity requirements see: Valid applications guidance.

Related content

[Contents](#)

Visit: evidence

This section gives information on how to make a decision on a visitor application.

Standard and burden of proof and evidence

When assessing whether the applicant meets the requirements of the Visitor rules the burden of proof is on the applicant to show they meet the validity and eligibility requirements, but when considering suitability, the burden of proof may shift to the Home Office.

The standard of proof you must apply is the balance of probabilities (which means it is more likely than not).

You must assess the applicant's credibility and intentions to visit the UK or to extend their stay as a visitor and decide whether they meet the requirements in the Visitor rules. You must be satisfied that the applicant is a genuine visitor.

Visitors can undertake multiple permitted activities whilst they are in the UK, but the applicant should be able to explain what their main reason for coming to the UK is at the visa application stage, on entry and when applying to extend their stay.

It is the applicant's responsibility to ensure they provide sufficient evidence to satisfy you that they meet the Visitor rules.

You must assess all the information provided by the applicant (unless it is a document that should not be sent with the application – see [the customer guidance on supporting documents for visitors](#)) – and any other evidence that may be relevant to the application. This should include any locally held information, but see Grounds for refusal and cancellation (suitability) guidance (Part Suitability) for when that information needs to be put to the applicant before a decision is made. Make an assessment considering all factors relevant to the application. See also guidance on [visit: genuineness and credibility](#).

Mandatory documents

The Visitor rules require specific mandatory evidence from certain types of visitors and for certain activities. The [supporting documents guidance](#) sets out the additional evidence required for the different types of visits.

Other documents

You must be satisfied that the applicant is a genuine visitor. Look at their personal circumstances, their stated purpose of visit, their travel history and record of compliance and whether they have adequate funds to cover the costs of their trip or, if they are applying to extend their stay, of the additional time they are seeking to stay in the UK as a visitor.

Supporting documents should back up evidence statements made on the visa application form. In relation to financial details and documents, there should be a correlation between the information applicants have declared on their application form (such as income, large account deposits and / or support received by family / friends), and the actual evidence provided to substantiate this. For example: that financial documents provided by any applicant should confirm the declared income / source of support and show sufficient funds available, such as bank statements which detail the origin of the funds held.

The [supporting documents guidance for applicants](#) includes:

- a list of documents that applicants might want to send in to support the statements on their application form (these are not mandatory - if an applicant does not send one of the recommended documents this failure is not of itself a ground for refusal)
- a list of documents we ask applicants **not** to send in If:
 - an applicant does submit a document on that list you should not consider it
 - you exceptionally want to see one of the documents on the list you should contact the applicant to request it

For visa applications, locally held information will help determine what types of supporting evidence is available in different countries.

You must not ask for or accept a written guarantee or undertaking from the applicant concerning the length of their stay.

At the border, whether you ask for supporting evidence will depend on the questions you ask and the answers the applicant gives.

For applications for permission to stay, the applicant will be asked to provide supporting evidence based on the information given in the application form. If you require additional evidence, you should contact the applicant to ask for it.

If you have concerns about the genuineness of a document, you should try to verify it at source; see guidance on document verification.

Refusals

You should refuse if the applicant has not provided sufficient evidence to satisfy you, on the balance of probabilities, that they meet the requirements of the Visitor rules. See also the [guidance on burden of proof and evidence](#) and [genuineness and credibility](#) and guidance on Grounds for refusal and cancellation (suitability) under Part Suitability.

The reasons for refusal must be factual, clear, and relevant to the application. On whatever ground you are refusing or cancelling entry clearance or permission to enter / stay, you must have evidence to support the reasons why you are not satisfied that the applicant meets the requirements.

Refusal wording

For visa applications, you should use the following refusal templates:

- Visit no right of appeal refusal letter template for all visit visa refusals that do not have a right of appeal
- Visit right of appeal refusal letter template for all visit visa refusals that attract a right of appeal on human rights grounds

For further information about refusal notices for visit visa applications, including relevant refusal paragraphs, see Visit: refusal notice guidance.

For refusals at the border or refusals of extensions of stay you should use the template and paragraphs on the case - working system, refusing in line with the Visitor rules at [Appendix V: Visitor](#).

For suitability refusals under Part Suitability see: [Immigration Rules](#) and Grounds for refusal and cancellation (suitability) guidance.

Related content

[Contents](#)

Visit: genuineness and credibility

This section gives information on what being a genuine visitor means.

Assessing an applicant's genuine intentions to visit

See: paragraph V 4.2 of [Appendix V: Visitor](#).

You must be satisfied that the applicant meets all the requirements of V 4.2 to V 4.6 of the Visitor rules and is a genuine visitor. If you are not satisfied, you must refuse their application. A visitor can enter, or extend their stay, to do different permitted activities but they should be expected to have a main reason or reasons for visiting, for example for business or a holiday, and be able to provide details. However, particularly where a visitor holds a long-term, multiple entry visit visa valid for 2, 5 or 10 years, it is likely that their reason for visiting will differ over time. This is permissible, provided they continue to intend to undertake one or more of the permitted visitor activities.

If a visitor is assessed as not meeting the requirements of being a genuine visitor under V.4.2-3, this is distinct and separate from suitability under Part Suitability.

See also [burden of proof and evidence](#).

Assessing an applicant's personal circumstances

See: paragraph V 4.2 of [Appendix V: Visitor](#).

The following factors will help you assess if an applicant is a genuine visitor:

- their previous immigration history, including visits to the UK and other countries
- the duration of previous visits and whether this was significantly longer than they originally stated on their visa application or on arrival - if this is the case, you should not automatically presume that the visitor is not genuine, but this may be a reason to question the applicant's overall intentions
- their financial circumstances as well as their family, social and economic background
- their personal and economic ties to their country of residence
- the cumulative period the applicant has visited the UK and their pattern of travel over the last 12-month period, and whether this amounts to 'de-facto' residence in the UK
- whether, on the balance of probabilities, the information and the reasons for the visit or for extending their stay provided by the applicant are credible and correspond to their personal, family, social and economic background

Travel / immigration history

You must consider the applicant's travel history in their passport or travel document (and, for visa applications, that listed on the application form). A pattern of travel that shows the applicant has previously complied with UK immigration law may indicate the applicant is likely to be a genuine visitor, as might travel to other countries, especially the USA, Canada, Australia, New Zealand, Ireland, Schengen countries or Switzerland.

If an applicant has previously failed to comply with another country's immigration law, for example if they have been removed from another country, or if they have been refused entry to another country, this may suggest that an applicant is not likely to be a genuine visitor (depending on the circumstances).

Travel history should not be the only consideration in deciding whether you are satisfied an applicant is a genuine visitor. There may have been a change in circumstances since previous travel. You should consider all relevant information for each application including any social and economic factors and any locally held information.

Where the applicant is a first-time traveller, you will need to rely on other evidence to satisfy you they are a genuine visitor.

Frequent or successive visits: how to assess if an applicant is making the UK their main home or place of work or study

See: paragraph V 4.2(b) of [Appendix V: Visitor](#).

You should check the visitor's travel history, including how long they are spending in the UK and how frequently they are returning. You must assess if they are, in effect, living in the UK through frequent or successive visits or making the UK their main home.

You should look at:

- the stated purpose of the visit and intended length of stay
- the number of visits made over the past 12 months, including the length of stay on each occasion, the time elapsed since the last visit, and if this amounts to the individual spending more time in the UK than in their home country
- the purpose of return trips to the applicant's home country or trips out of the Common Travel Area and if these are used only to seek re-entry to the UK
- the links they have with their home country or ordinary country of residence - consider especially any long-term commitments and where the applicant is registered for tax purposes
- evidence the UK is their main place of residence, for example:
 - if they have registered with a general practitioner (GP)
 - if they send their children to UK schools

- the history of previous applications, for example if the visitor has previously been refused under the Family rules and subsequently wants to enter as a visitor you must assess if they are using the visitor route to avoid the rules in place for family migrants joining British or settled persons in the UK

There is no specified maximum period, which an individual can spend in the UK in any period, such as '6 months in 12 months' (if each visit does not exceed the maximum period for that visit, normally 6 months). However, if it is clear from an applicant's travel history that they are seeking to remain in the UK for extended periods or making the UK their home you should refuse their application.

Reasons for doubting whether the applicant is a genuine visitor

See: paragraph V 4.2 of [Appendix V: Visitor](#).

This is not an exhaustive list but may help with your assessment. If:

- the applicant has few or no family and economic ties to their country of residence, and has several family members in the UK - for example a person with most of their family in the UK and no job or studies in their own country may be considered to have few ties to their home country
- the applicant, their sponsor (if they are visiting a friend or relative) or other immediate family member has, or has attempted to, deceive the Home Office in a previous application for entry clearance, permission to enter or stay
- there are discrepancies between the statements made by the applicant and the statements made by the sponsor, particularly on points where the sponsor could reasonably be expected to know the facts but does not
- it has not been possible to verify information provided by the applicant despite attempts to do so
- the information that has been provided or the reasons for the visit stated by the applicant are not credible
- a search of the applicant's baggage and vehicle at the border reveals items which demonstrate they intend to work or live in the UK

Credibility and intentions: borderline decisions

See: paragraphs V 4.2 of [Appendix V: Visitor](#).

For visa applications, if you are satisfied that the applicant meets all the Visitor rules you should grant the visa, but if some aspects remain of concern, you should consider whether to grant a [short duration visa](#).

At the border, you must use code 3 if the applicant meets all the Visitor rules, but some aspects remain of concern. You should consider granting under code 3 for the duration required for the stated purpose of visit, rather than granting permission for 6 months.

See [Recording requirements for UKVI and Border Force: Credibility and intentions – borderline decisions](#) for information you must record where you have residual doubts.

Related content

[Contents](#)

Visit: maintenance and accommodation and sponsorship

This section gives information on maintenance and accommodation requirements and sponsorship which applies to all visitors except transit.

Maintenance and accommodation

See: paragraphs V 4.2(e) and V 4.3 of [Appendix V: Visitor](#).

Check the applicant has access to sufficient resources to maintain and accommodate themselves adequately for the whole of their planned visit to the UK or for the period of any application for permission to stay. There is no set level of funds required for an applicant to show this.

At the border you may want to ask where the applicant will be staying and ask for evidence that they have access to funds to cover the costs they are likely to incur during their visit.

For visa and permission to stay applications you should look at the application form and any financial supporting documents to assess this requirement. You should consider the likely cost of their stay and assess any sources of revenue that will continue to be available to the applicant whilst they are visiting the UK.

You must also take into account any ongoing financial commitments the applicant has in their country of residence such as rent / mortgage payments and any dependants who they support financially, including those who are not travelling with them.

Their income or savings, minus their financial commitments, must be sufficient to meet the likely costs they will incur in the UK and be reasonable expenditure in light of their financial situation.

Where an individual provides documents which show sufficient funds for their planned stay, but either all or most of these funds have not been held in their account for long, you may want to make further checks to establish the origin of this money.

Any funds relied upon by the applicant to demonstrate that they have sufficient funds must be held in a financial institution permitted under [Appendix Finance](#). See Financial requirements guidance for further information.

If the money is from a third party you must check whether the rules on [maintenance and accommodation provided by a third party](#) are met. If not, you should refuse. If the applicant has not declared the third-party support, for example on the application form, and they are unable to show that the funds are genuinely theirs, they should not be counted in any assessment.

Where a child is applying to come to the UK as a visitor or seeking to extend their stay, they are not expected to have funds in their own name. Instead, they may meet the requirement by showing they have access to funds from their parents or a third party.

At the border, if an unaccompanied child is travelling to the UK, you may want to ask for evidence about how their visit is to be funded.

Maintenance and accommodation provided by a third party

See: paragraph V 4.3 of [Appendix V: Visitor](#).

Maintenance and accommodation support can be provided by a third party, including family members, friends and other people with whom the applicant has a genuine personal or professional relationship. If the third party is in the UK, they must not be in breach of immigration law at the time of the decision on the visitor's application or their entry to the UK. Where that is not the case the support must be disregarded.

To assess whether the relationship with the third party is genuine and whether the third party intends to provide support consider:

- the third party's previous history of 'sponsoring' visitors - for example: previous failures to support visitors may call into question their intention and ability to do so for this application
- the relationship between the applicant and the third party

For visa applications, you may want to check with the applicant or third party:

- where and how they met
- how often and by what method they communicate

If the third party is an individual such as a friend or family member providing financial support for the applicant, they must satisfy you that they have enough funds available to adequately support themselves and anyone normally dependent on them, as well as the applicant.

Where you believe it is more likely than not that the third party will be unable to provide this support, you may refuse the application.

Other third-party support (non-financial)

Only third parties providing maintenance and accommodation are mentioned in the Visitor rules. Sometimes third parties such as MPs may seek to provide undertakings in support of a visit application. These cannot be considered as a guarantee that the visitor will comply with the terms of their permission. You should not actively seek out such an undertaking or accept an offer to provide one.

Where a third-party undertaking in support is provided with an application, you may consider it as a factor relevant to establishing the applicant's credibility and intentions, but it should not be accepted as evidence of maintenance and accommodation.

See '[Recording requirements for UKVI: MP letter in support of an application](#)' on what to do when an MP writes to a visa application centre in support of an application.

Payment for visitors

See: [Appendix Visitor: Permitted Activities](#), [Appendix Visitor: Permit Free Festival List](#), paragraphs V 4.6 of [Appendix V: Visitor](#).

Visitors may only receive payment from a UK source in specific circumstances as set out at V 4.6 of [Appendix V: Visitor](#). This must not equate to a salary - where this is the case, you must refuse the application.

At the border, you may want to ask whether the applicant will be being paid in the UK for any activities. See guidance on [permitted paid engagements](#).

Artists, entertainers, and musicians visiting the UK can receive payment for performances at one or more of the festivals listed on the [Permit Free Festival list](#). They will usually have an invitation letter from the festival organisers, although this is not a mandatory requirement.

Related content

[Contents](#)

Visit: prohibited and permitted activities for visitors

This section gives information on visitors coming to the UK for tourism, to visit friends and family, for business, work related reasons or to transit the UK on route to another country.

Tourism and leisure

See: paragraph PA 2 (a) of [Appendix Visitor: Permitted Activities](#) and paragraph V 6.1 (for ADS) of [Appendix V: Visitor](#).

For visa applications, visitors are not required to provide an itinerary, but you should normally expect the applicant to have some plans for their stay and provide information about this on the application form.

At the border, you should expect the applicant to be able to answer questions on what they plan to do in the UK.

Educational exchange visits

See: paragraph PA 2 (b) of [Appendix Visitor: Permitted Activities](#)

You must check that the students are in full time education in their home country and that any teachers or other adults accompanying the group are employed overseas.

Exchanges and educational visits may be with a state funded school or academy or an independent school and should be mainly about broadening horizons and deepening intercultural understanding. These visits do not have a specified time limit but you should look at the nature of the visit, and if it is for longer than 30 days make sure it does not amount to a course of study, as study is not permitted at state funded schools or academies and only at independent schools if following the rules around study as a visitor.

See Department For Education (DfE) link for further information as admission to state funded schools or academies is not an immigration matter. [School applications for foreign national children and children resident outside England](#)

The precise nature of the visit is for the school to decide. You may wish to see evidence of a programme of cultural visits or other activities to satisfy you that the programme is a short exchange.

For visits by those under the age of 16 (or under 18 if they have a disability) which are longer than 28 days, see guidance on [private foster care](#).

Recreational study

See: paragraph PA 2 (c) of [Appendix Visitor: Permitted Activities](#)

Recreational study can be undertaken for up to 30 days. The 30 days do not have to be consecutive and can be split across the visitor's permission to be in the UK. A recreational course is a course undertaken purely for leisure purposes that does not lead to a formal qualification, for example: a leisure course in pottery or horse riding, but not English language training. It can also include recreational courses undertaken as part of corporate team building. Any bona fide institution in the UK that is not a state funded school or academy can offer recreational courses. Courses that lead to formal qualifications are not considered recreational. Qualifications for this purpose do not include attendance certificates. Courses that do lead to a formal qualification should be undertaken at an accredited institution as per the requirements of V 9.1 of [Appendix V: Visitor](#). See [guidance on study for visitors](#).

Volunteering

See: paragraph PA 3 of [Appendix Visitor: Permitted Activities](#)

Visitors may undertake volunteering provided it is for a registered charity and will be for no longer than 30 days in total. The 30 days do not have to be consecutive and can be split across the visitor's period of permission to be in the UK. Visitors may not undertake voluntary work; you must be clear on the difference between the two.

Voluntary workers:

- often have a contract with their employer (this means the employer must provide the work and the voluntary worker must attend at particular times and carry out specific tasks)
- are also usually remunerated in kind

Volunteers:

- do not have a contract of employment
- must not take the place of an employee
- must not receive payment in kind but reimbursement for reasonable travel and subsistence expenses is allowed
- support a charity or voluntary or public sector organisation, but must not be undertaking work ancillary to the organisation's charitable purpose, for example:
 - routine back office administrative roles
 - retail or other sales roles
 - fund-raising roles and roles involved in the maintenance of the organisation's offices and other assets

Voluntary work is provided for in the Charity Worker route of the points-based system.

Assessing whether the applicant intends to do work or employment which is prohibited for a visitor

See: paragraphs V 4.4 to V 4.5 of [Appendix V: Visitor](#).

For visa applications you should consider whether the information provided about the applicant's purpose for visiting and activities to be undertaken would amount to prohibited work under V 4.4 or V 4.5. Permitted activities under [Appendix Visitor: Permitted Activities](#) must not amount to employment or filling a role even on a temporary basis. Where you consider the information provided means that this is the case, you should refuse the application and notify the sponsor management team in case the organisation holds a sponsor licence.

See [Recording requirements for UKVI: employers using visitors to undertake work or fill a role](#) for information that you must record and details of where to send this information to.

At the border you will need to ask the applicant to explain what they are coming to do and for how long. Where you are satisfied that the information provided means the activities amount to prohibited work under V 4.4 or V 4.5, you should refuse entry.

The reasons for refusing a visa or permission to enter, or cancelling permission, must be clear and supported by evidence. For example:

- refusal on the ground you are not satisfied that an applicant is a genuine visitor because they will be undertaking an activity that is prohibited for visitors (paragraphs V 4.4 to V 4.6) should be supported by information in the visa application form or from examination of the applicant at the border
- it may be considered that an applicant is intending to directly sell goods or services to the public as opposed to negotiating and signing deals or contracts:
 - the former is a prohibited activity for visitors whereas the latter activity is permitted
 - the information in the visa application form or from questioning the applicant would need to support the assessment of whether they intend to undertake a prohibited activity

Where a family member is coming to look after a child in the UK, this is permitted provided it is for a short visit and does not amount to the relative being employed as a child-minder. You must be satisfied that the visit is of a short duration, the relative is a genuine visitor and will not live in the UK for extended periods through frequent or successive visits.

Visitors are not permitted to act as **au-pairs** for families in the UK, as this is considered to be providing a service, which is not permitted as per V 4.4 (a) (vi) of [Appendix V: Visitor](#). If a visitor states that this is their intention, you should refuse their application.

Permitted activities for visitors: business and other work-related activities

See: [Appendix Visitor: Permitted Activities](#), [Appendix Visitor: Permit Free Festival List](#) and paragraphs V 13.1 – V 13.3 of [Appendix V: Visitor](#).

Check that the applicant has explained their main reason for coming to the UK and that this is one of the permitted activities. For visa applicants this will be on their application form. At the border you may want to ask.

There is no provision in the Visitor route for family members, other than as the dependant of a visitor undertaking academic activities for more than 6 months, to stay with individuals for the duration of their visit. However, they can enter to visit providing that they are not making frequent or successive visits to reside in the UK for extended periods.

Business activities will normally be linked to the person's employment overseas and activities for visitors are mostly incidental to their employment. Some activities require a visitor to do a part of their overseas role from the UK, for example a driver on an international route delivering or collecting goods or passengers between the UK and another country. In all cases the duration of activities must be less than 6 months and prearranged where possible. Where they are not, you should check who will be covering the applicant's role whilst they are in the UK and assess whether the activities in fact amount to work that must be carried out under the work routes.

General business activities

See: paragraph PA 4 of [Appendix Visitor: Permitted Activities](#).

You should assess whether the amount of time the applicant intends to spend in the UK is credible in view of the activities the applicant is seeking to do and be satisfied that they are not coming to work or make the UK their main place of work. For visa applications this evidence might be included in a letter from an employer.

A visitor can attend conferences or seminars. Whilst most will be formal speaker-led events usually lasting for a couple of days and focussed on a specific topic or sector, they can also include familiarisation programmes for people coming to learn about UK practices on law or finance for example. However, you must ensure this does not amount to the person undertaking recreational study for more than 30 days or work experience.

There is no restriction on the duration of a conference, but it would be reasonable to expect the activity to last no more than a couple of weeks. Where a conference is longer, you should check that it does not amount to work.

Coming to the UK for general discussions to secure funding for a project is permitted under the Visitor rules. However, it is not possible for visitors undertaking these activities to switch into the Innovator Founder Visa route, in line with the wider switching principles of the points-based immigration system.

Job seeking

See: paragraph PA 4 of [Appendix Visitor: Permitted Activities](#).

Visitors are permitted to come to the UK to attend job interviews. However, you must be satisfied that should the applicant be successful in obtaining employment they will leave the UK and seek the appropriate entry clearance prior to commencing work. In assessing whether they are a genuine visitor, you should consider the nature of the employment that they are seeking and whether there is an entry clearance route available for such employment.

Remote working

See: paragraph PA 4 of [Appendix Visitor: Permitted Activities](#).

Visitors are permitted to undertake activities relating to their employment overseas remotely whilst they are in the UK, such as responding to emails, answering phone calls or participating in remote meetings. However, you should check that the applicant's primary purpose for coming to the UK is to undertake another permitted activity, rather than specifically to work remotely from the UK.

When assessing whether a visitor's primary purpose is to undertake remote work you should consider the proposed length of their stay and whether a stay of such a length would be financially viable without remote working on an ongoing basis. Where you believe that the viability of a visit substantially relies on an individual supporting themselves financially through remote work, you should consider that work to be the primary purpose of their visit.

Visitors are likely to stay for less than one month whilst undertaking remote work as a secondary activity because they will be in employment overseas. If they request longer, you should look carefully at what they will be doing in the UK and be content that their primary purpose is not remote working. Activities lasting more than 90 days are not an automatic ground for refusal but may lead to questions about the nature of their remote work.

Where a visitor is coming to the UK to undertake permitted business activities, such as attending meetings or conferences, they can also work remotely as part of their overseas employment, however you should also ensure that this does not amount to the applicant being seconded to a UK company or organisation, or to the UK branch of their overseas employer.

Where the applicant indicates that they intend to spend a large proportion of their time in the UK and will be doing some remote working, you should ensure that they are genuinely employed overseas and are not seeking to work in the UK.

You must be satisfied that the applicant will not live in the UK for extended periods through [frequent or successive visits](#).

Intra-corporate activities

See: paragraphs PA 5.1 to PA 5.2 and PA 6 of [Appendix Visitor: Permitted Activities](#).

Intra-corporate activities should be of a short duration, linked to a specific project, and where the visitor will be directly working with or for clients, this should not be the primary purpose of their visit to the UK.

When assessing whether an applicant's primary purpose is to work with or for clients you should consider the role of the UK branch of the corporate group. If the applicant is travelling to the UK to support their UK based colleagues on a project being led from the UK branch, and this naturally leads to the applicant working directly with clients, this is acceptable. However, if the applicant is travelling to the UK to undertake activities under PA.5 directly with clients, independently of a project led from the UK branch, then you should refuse the application, as the client facing work will not be incidental to the applicant's employment overseas.

You must be satisfied that the applicant is not coming to fill a role in the company which must be done under the Global Business Mobility route or routes. If that is the case, the application must be refused.

There are no restrictions on the nature of regulatory audits providing they are internal to the group of companies (including branch and subsidiary). You may want to check company records online to confirm if the companies are part of the same group.

An example of an audit is inspecting the quality of car productions at a manufacturing plant.

Manufacturing and supply of goods

See: paragraph PA 7 of [Appendix Visitor: Permitted Activities](#).

This activity is in place to provide for the commitments the UK has taken in trade agreements.

This activity could arise in the following circumstances:

- if the overseas company is the manufacturer, or manufactured a component of the machinery, equipment, computer software or hardware
- if the overseas company supplied the machinery, equipment, computer software or hardware
- if the machinery, equipment, computer software or hardware has been supplied or manufactured by a larger corporate group and the service, installation or repair function is undertaken by employees of a different company within the same corporate group and this arrangement was clear at the time when the contract of purchase, supply or lease was concluded
- if the manufacturer or supplier subcontracts the installation or maintenance of the machinery, equipment, computer software or hardware to another separate

overseas company and this arrangement was clear at the time when the contract of purchase, supply or lease was concluded

- if the employee of the overseas company is required, for safety reasons, to operate equipment, machinery, or hardware that is being provided under contract of purchase, supply or lease to a UK company or organisation

You may wish to see evidence of the contract between the overseas and UK based company which should specify the arrangements in place for the after sales service. If you have doubts or concerns, then you should contact the UK based company to verify the arrangement.

If the contract of sale was between EU and UK based companies and predates the UK's exit from the EU, the contract may not include details of the after sales service. In these cases, you may consider other evidence such as a letter from the UK based company setting out the nature of the service contract in place and the date the EU based company began providing this service.

Visitors are likely to stay for less than one month to carry out this activity because they will be in employment overseas. If they request longer, you should look carefully at what they will be doing in the UK and be sure they are not filling a role in the UK company. Activities lasting more than 90 days are not an automatic ground for refusal but may lead to questions about their intention to be in the UK for a short visit and how they will be able to continue their overseas role.

Clients of UK export companies

See: paragraph PA 8 of [Appendix Visitor: Permitted Activities](#).

You should check if there is a contract of service between the two companies for the UK company to provide goods or services to the overseas company. An example would be a UK company contracting defence services to an overseas company (companies must not be part of the same corporate group). Employees of the overseas company can work with the UK company to oversee delivery of the contract. Repeat visits are possible if the duration of the contract is for more than 6 months but there should be a clear end date for the work.

Overseas roles requiring specific activities in the UK

See: paragraph PA 9 of [Appendix Visitor: Permitted Activities](#).

It is possible for certain types of people who are employed abroad and remain so to visit the UK to carry out their work. You must check the visitor continues to be employed and paid overseas. Personal assistants and bodyguards who are supporting an overseas businessperson on their visit must not be providing personal care or doing domestic work for them in the UK – they must use the Overseas Domestic Worker route for this.

Wet lease agreements

Pilots or members of cabin crew who are coming to the UK to work on an aircraft that is being leased to a UK airline as part of a Civil Aviation Authority wet lease agreement will often be based in the UK for long periods (in some cases for up to 6 months). This is acceptable however you should ensure that they will remain employed and paid by the overseas employer for the duration of their stay and are not being employed in the UK.

Work-related training

See: paragraph PA 10.2 of [Appendix Visitor: Permitted Activities](#).

Training should be in work practices and techniques that are not available in the visitor's home country. It should typically be classroom based or involve familiarisation or observation. Practical training is allowed provided it does not amount to 'training on the job' or the person filling a role. It is acceptable for a visitor to learn how to use a piece of equipment in the UK, but you must carefully assess how long they intend to do this for and make sure there is no risk that they will be working for the host company in the UK.

Where you think the training is available in their home country, you may want to question why the visitor needs to come to the UK.

If the visitor states that they will be being trained for longer than one month, you should consider who will be covering their work overseas and whether their training activities amount to taking employment in the UK.

Graduates of medical, dental or nursing schools

See: paragraph PA 10.1 of [Appendix Visitor: Permitted Activities](#) and paragraphs V 11.1 to V 11.13 and V 15.3 to V 15.4 of [Appendix V: Visitor](#).

Whilst visitors who are undertaking an unpaid clinical attachment cannot be responsible for the treatment of patients, they can undertake ancillary tasks whilst under supervision.

Where a person is undertaking the PLAB (Professional and Linguistic Assessments Board) or OSCE (Objective Structured Clinical Examination) tests this will not usually include any study in the UK. The applicant must provide confirmation of their test from the General Medical Council or Nursing and Midwifery Council.

Where an individual successfully passes the PLAB test and wishes to remain in the UK they can only do so if it is for an unpaid clinical attachment as specified in the Visitor rules.

Individuals can enter as visitors to sit a test or an exam in the UK, such as those for entry into one of the Royal Colleges.

Science, research and academia

See: paragraph PA 11.1 of [Appendix Visitor: Permitted Activities](#), and V 10.1 of [Appendix V: Visitor](#).

When determining whether a senior doctor or dentist is eminent you should consider whether they have been working for a number of years in their profession. They may come to the UK to take part in research, teaching, or clinical practice if this does not amount to taking employment in the UK.

Academics who are applying for a 12 month visit visa, or an extension to complete 12 months as an academic carrying out the activities referred to in V 10.1 of [Appendix V: Visitor](#), must be highly qualified within their field of expertise and working in that field at an academic or higher education institution overseas before entering the UK. This will generally be people with PhDs or higher. If the applicant does not provide evidence of this, you can usually find a biography on the relevant institution's website.

Academics who want to come to the UK for 6 months or less do not need to meet the additional requirements at V 10.1 of [Appendix V: Visitor](#).

Legal

See: paragraph PA 12.1 to PA 12.2 of [Appendix Visitor: Permitted Activities](#).

Where a person is summoned to the UK to attend a court hearing and there are reasons to doubt their intentions, you should check whether their evidence could be given by video-link by contacting the court. Any person summoned by a UK court would need to provide evidence to confirm why their attendance in person is necessary.

Religion

See: paragraph PA 13 of [Appendix Visitor: Permitted Activities](#).

You should check that the person is not seeking to take up an office, post or appointment in the UK.

Religious workers can undertake pastoral duties which can include one-off engagements such as conducting wedding ceremonies or funerals, provided these are one-off engagements for which they are not receiving payment and they continue to be in employment overseas. If they want to work in the UK, they should consider applying under Appendix Temporary Work - Religious Worker or Appendix T2 Minister of Religion.

Creative

See: paragraphs PA 14.1 to PA 14.3 of [Appendix Visitor: Permitted Activities](#).

An artist can include anyone coming to the UK to undertake an activity that is connected to the arts, such as literature, performing arts, visual arts or culinary arts. There is no restriction on amateur or professional artists doing permitted activities. Examples include:

- poets
- film crew (including crew for online media content, for example YouTube)
- photographers
- designers
- artists
- musicians
- writers
- conductors

Entertainers can include anyone coming to the UK to undertake an activity that is connected to the performing arts, for example dancers, comedians, members of circus acts, members of film crew or those participating in e-sport competitions.

Personal or technical staff who are attending the same event can accompany the artist, entertainer, or musician to the UK, provided they are employed to work for them overseas. Examples include, but are not restricted to:

- choreographers
- stage managers
- make-up artists
- personal bodyguards
- press officers

Sport

See: paragraphs PA 15.1 to PA 15.2 of [Appendix Visitor: Permitted Activities](#).

You must consider whether the individual is being employed as a professional sportsperson by a team based in the UK. If that is the case, you should refuse and inform the applicant to consider applying under the work routes.

Sportspersons can take part in tournaments or events, however if the applicant intends to participate in a professional domestic championship or league, including where one or more of the fixtures or rounds takes place outside the UK, this is classed as employment (paid or unpaid).

Amateur sportspersons can join an amateur team or club to gain experience in a particular sport, provided they are an amateur in that sport. You must consider whether the individual is an amateur or not, as well as the amateur status of the team or club. An individual is not permitted to join an amateur team or club as a visitor if they are a professional sportsperson or the team or club is not an amateur one and you must refuse the application.

It should be possible to confirm the team or club's status on their website or on the website of the sport's governing body. for example: the England and Wales Cricket Board for cricket, or for football on the websites of the relevant leagues, for example the English, Scottish, Welsh, and Northern Irish football leagues.

"Amateur" means a person who engages in a sport or creative activity solely for personal enjoyment and who is not seeking to derive a living from the activity.

"Professional Sportsperson" means a person who is one or more of the following:

- a. currently providing services as a sportsperson, or is playing or coaching in any capacity, at a professional or semi-professional level of sport (whether paid or unpaid); or
- b. currently receiving payment, including payment in kind, for playing or coaching, and that payment covers all, or the majority of, their costs for travelling to, and living in, the UK, or has received such payment within the previous four years; or
- c. currently registered to a professional or semi-professional sports team, or has been so registered within the previous four years (this includes all academy and development team age groups); or
- d. has represented their nation or national team within the previous two years, including all youth and development age groups from under 17s upwards; or
- e. has represented their state or regional team within the previous two years, including all youth and development age groups from under 17s upwards; or
- f. has an established international reputation in their chosen field of sport; or
- g. engages an agent or representative, with the aim of finding opportunities as a sportsperson, and / or developing a current or future career as a sportsperson, or has engaged such an agent in the last 12 months; or
- h. is providing services as a sportsperson or coach, unless they are doing so as an "Amateur" in a charity event; or
- i. is providing services as a sportsperson or coach, unless they are doing so as a student who is studying a course at a degree level or above at a higher education provider and playing or coaching sport as an "Amateur" or as part of a work placement that is undertaken as an integral and assessed part of their course.

Some examples of those likely to be included in the definition of 'professional sportsperson' are:

- players who have played for professional or semi-professional clubs at junior levels, which may include under 17s and under 19s teams, whether they were paid or not
- coaches of junior teams of professional or semi-professional clubs, whether they were paid or not
- former professional sportspeople who have formally reverted to amateur status according to the rules of their sport
- players who have played representative sport for their state, country, or territory, whether they were paid or not
- those who have engaged agents to find opportunities to provide their services as a sportsperson or a coach

- those travelling solely to play or coach sport who have their expenses wholly or largely paid for them

Technical or support staff for sportspersons must be attending the same event as the sportsperson and be employed to work for them overseas. Examples include:

- physiotherapists
- coaches
- dieticians
- bodyguards
- press officers
- polo grooms, but only when they are accompanying a polo player and not intending to base themselves in the UK for the sporting season to take up employment in the stables

Sports officials are permitted to support a sports tournament or event, providing they have been invited by either: a UK based sports organisation, agent, or broadcaster; or a sportsperson who is attending the same tournament or event (although there is no requirement for the sports official to be employed by that sportsperson overseas). Examples of sports officials may include:

- lines people
- referees
- umpires

Permitted Paid Engagements

See: paragraph PA 19 of [Appendix Visitor: Permitted Activities](#), paragraphs V 13.1 to V 13.3 of [Appendix V: Visitor](#).

Visiting academic examiners or assessors

Experts will normally be employed outside the UK and therefore intend to return to this employment on completion of their engagement.

Where an academic is fully retired and carries out one-off examination work, this would not count as their full-time occupation, and you must refuse their application. However, an individual who is semi-retired, carrying out regular examination work and earning income from this, will qualify under this route.

Where the proposed activities include examining at a further education establishment, their application must be refused, as they must apply under the work routes to do this.

UK Higher Education Institution (HEI) means a body that receives public funding as a UK Higher Education Institution from either:

- The Department for Employment and Learning in Northern Ireland
- The Office for Students

- The Higher Education Funding Council for Wales
- The Scottish Funding Council
- Richmond, the American International University in London

Evidence

You must consider their employment overseas, which must be in a field relevant to their engagement here.

The invitation should show why the individual has been chosen to carry out the engagement (because of their skills or expertise) and set out how the engagement links to the venue and how long the engagement is for.

Other evidence could include publications by the applicant in their field of expertise or a letter from their employer confirming where they work and area of expertise.

Visiting lecturers

Experts must be employed outside the UK (this does not have to be as a full-time lecturer) and intend to return to this employment on completion of their engagement.

Where an expert is fully retired and carries out a one-off lecture, this will not count as their full-time occupation, and you must refuse their application. However, an individual who is semi-retired, carrying out regular lectures and earning income from this, will qualify under this route.

If an individual is invited to give a lecture at a Higher Education Institution as part of a course, then this is acceptable, providing they are not replacing the formal role of the course teacher at the Higher Education Institution (HEI) - (this would come under the points-based system).

The subject of their lecture will, in most cases, directly relate to the area in which they are employed overseas. In cases where they are coming to the UK to lecture on an unrelated area you must take care to verify the applicant's qualifications in this area, such as:

- any previous employment or posts held in this area
- publications on the subject
- other recognised qualifications

Evidence

Consider their employment overseas which must be in a field relevant to their engagement in the UK.

Other evidence can include:

- publications by the applicant in a particular field
- evidence of previous lectures given in that field of expertise

- a letter from their employer confirming where they work and area of expertise

Other recognised organisations who may invite visiting examiners / assessors / visiting lecturers for permitted paid engagements

The Home Office recognises publicly funded research institutions, such as:

- research organisations, which could include independent research organisations and those research council funded institutes
- museums (this must be the primary purpose of the venue)
- art galleries (where the primary purpose of the venue is to exhibit art as opposed to selling it or any other activity)
- arts centres, arts festivals, theatres, and other arts venues

Designated air pilot examiner

To make sure a training organisation is regulated by the Civil Aviation Authority (CAA) see the [Civil Aviation Authority website](#).

If you are unsure about the training organisation's status, you must contact the CAA to confirm they are an approved facility for providing flight training.

You must make sure the engagement relates to the applicant's expertise or qualifications, and full-time profession overseas. Given the nature of this engagement the applicant must be employed overseas as a member of that country's national aviation authority, for example the Federal Aviation Authority in the USA.

Qualified lawyers

Qualified lawyer covers:

- counsel
- advocates
- attorneys
- barristers
- solicitors

In addition to advocacy and dispute resolution work, lawyers entering under these provisions are permitted to take an active role in the preparation of a hearing which may need one or more preparatory visit or visits.

Where it is clear from the invitation or other information the case is likely to last longer than one month, you must find out if the applicant's involvement will be required for the entire duration. If it is, you must refuse the application on the basis that they are intending to undertake a permitted paid engagement for longer than 30 days.

If the qualified lawyer is representing a client based overseas, the engagement must still relate to a UK-based hearing. Rights of audience are not required for:

- arbitration
- other alternative dispute resolution hearings
- certain tribunal hearings

Evidence

They must provide confirmation of the lawyer's right of audience (or 'temporary call'), where required, which would allow an overseas lawyer to represent a client in a UK court.

Lawyers can be expected to demonstrate their qualifications. It is common to show a practising certificate or certificate of good standing. This document will vary depending on the regulatory body involved.

Arts, entertainment or sporting professionals

A creative organisation includes all organisations involved in artistic and entertainment activities. Examples include galleries, arts faculties or departments in universities and schools, and venues involved in producing or staging of events. Embassies putting on cultural events related to the country concerned are also in scope. UK based agents and broadcasters can also invite individuals to undertake a permitted paid engagement in the UK. You must be satisfied that the inviting organisation is legitimate.

A sports organisation includes any organisation involved in organising or staging sporting events or matches.

To qualify, applicants must be able to demonstrate that this is their full-time profession. In assessing this you must consider factors such as:

- standing
- reputation
- earnings, recognising that some artists may earn lower salaries in certain countries
- existing work commitments outside of the UK

An arts professional can work in fields across the performing and creative arts such as a poet, make-up artist, stylist, set designer, photographer, or a traditional artist (this is not an exhaustive list).

Fashion models who are coming to the UK to undertake a specific engagement can use this route, providing they do not intend to make the UK their home.

Artists may be taking part in activities such as:

- judging panels
- giving lectures
- talking about, presenting, or launching their work to other professionals or the public
- performances
- panel debates
- professional conferences

Evidence

They must also provide evidence to show they are an established professional artist, entertainer, or sports professional, such as:

- publications they have produced
- publicity material for performances, screenings, concerts, talks, readings, or exhibitions
- evidence of awards
- media coverage and reviews
- proof of recent performances

Speakers at conferences

Speakers may be invited to a wide range of events, such as business events, or one-off or a series of lectures in an academic setting. If the speaker is being invited to a trade fair you should ensure that they are not going to be directly selling to the public.

All PPEs must be pre-arranged with a formal invitation prior to travelling to the UK and that the PPE activity to be undertaken is within the first 30 days of arrival as a visitor.

Offshore worker notification requirements

The Immigration (Offshore Worker Notification and Exemption from Control (Amendment) Regulations 2023 set out that from 12 April 2023, an offshore worker must report when they arrive in, and leave, UK waters. An offshore worker is a person who arrive in UK waters (the territorial sea and inland waters) for the purpose of undertaking work in those waters and where they do not first enter the UK landmass.

If a visitor arrives directly into UK waters to undertake permitted activities in those waters during their stay, they will be classified as an offshore worker and if they do not have a sponsor will be required to notify the Home Office each time they arrive in and leave UK waters by emailing the offshore worker notification inbox.

The email should include the following information:

- name, date of birth, nationality
- date they arrived in, or left, UK waters (as appropriate)

- activity being undertaken in UK waters
- immigration route which they are arriving in / leaving from UK waters on
- vessel name

The relevant notification must be made:

- no earlier than the date they arrived in or left (whichever is relevant) UK waters
- no later than 10 working days after the date they arrived in or left (whichever is relevant) UK waters

Alternatively, notifications can be made by post to:

Economic Migration Unit
PO Box 3468
Sheffield
S3 8WA

Study for visitors

See: paragraph PA 17 of [Appendix Visitor: Permitted Activities](#), paragraphs V 9.1 to V 9.5 of [Appendix V: Visitor](#).

A visitor can come to the UK to:

- study a course at an accredited institution (meaning one or more consecutive or concurrent programmes of study that will be completed within the validity period of the visitor permission)
- undertake research or research tuition (for example: to learn about research)
- complete one or more (unpaid) elective courses linked to their overseas study, where they are studying medicine, nursing, midwifery, veterinary medicine and science, or dentistry as their principal course of study equivalent to at least degree level study in the UK
- complete a study-abroad programme in the UK as part of an overseas course, where the programme is less than 6 months in length
- sit an entrance exam
- re-sit an examination or retake a module
- take an oral (viva) examination for part of a PhD qualification at a UK institution

If a visitor is coming to the UK to study, other than up to 30 days recreational study, you must check they have been accepted for a course of study at an [accredited institution](#). All English language training must be undertaken at an accredited institution even if it will last less than 30 days.

If a visitor is coming to the UK to complete a short period of research, to learn how to conduct research or to complete an elective or electives, you must check that the applicant meets the requirements. They must:

- be studying a course overseas that is the equivalent of a UK degree level course ([Ecctis](#) provide information about course equivalence)

- the research or elective must form part of, or be relevant to, the course and the applicant must provide confirmation of this from their overseas education provider
- have been accepted by a UK higher education provider, which is funded by one of the following bodies, to do research, be taught about research (research tuition) or to complete an elective at the UK institution:
 - [Department for the Economy in Northern Ireland](#)
 - [Office for Students](#)
 - [Higher Education Funding Council for Wales](#)
 - [Scottish Funding Council](#)

Applicants who apply for a visit visa or permission to enter to complete research or research tuition as a visitor must meet the requirements of paragraphs V 9.4 – V 9.5 of [Appendix V: Visitor](#).

Where the higher education provider has entered a partnership with a research institute to teach courses to master's and / or PhD students, the research institute must either be:

- [listed](#) as being in receipt of UK Research and Innovation and its Councils grant funding, or
- [listed](#) as a research institute with which the Research Councils have established a long-term involvement as a major funder and which is eligible to receive research funding

A visitor cannot be employed as a sponsored researcher - to do so they must apply under the work routes.

Visitors are not allowed to enrol on a course of study that includes a work placement or work experience, with the exception of an elective course of study which meets the requirements set out in paragraph V 9.3 of [Appendix V: Visitor](#).

Whilst visitors who are undertaking a medical, nursing, midwifery, veterinary or dentistry elective cannot be responsible for the treatment of patients, they can undertake supervised ancillary tasks.

Genuine study

As well as the considerations under [Genuineness and credibility](#), decision makers should also consider whether the proposed course of study is credible. The following factors may help you assess whether the study is credible:

- the length of time the applicant intends to study in the UK and how this might impact on their personal circumstances in their home country
- why the applicant is intending to undertake this course and how it relates to their personal circumstances in their home country
- whether the course is available elsewhere, including online
- whether the applicant intends to study at an accredited institution

- whether the applicant genuinely intends to study here on a course or courses that will be completed during their stay (except in the case of distance learning)
- whether the applicant has sufficient funds to undertake the course of study

You must be satisfied that they do not intend to use frequent and successive visits to circumvent the requirements of the Student or Child Student routes, that is, to pursue a longer course.

Studying at a UK Institution by distance learning

Students undertaking a course of study at a UK academic institution via distance learning should be studying for most of their time outside of the UK and only intend to come to the UK for short periods of time for certain activities, such as induction weeks, intensive face-to-face learning, one-to-one progress checks or to sit exams or assessments.

Due to the types of activities that might require a distance learner to be in the UK, you would not expect them to be in the UK for a long period of time and you should check to ensure that they are not using frequent or repeat visits to pursue a longer course that should be undertaken on the Student or Child Student routes.

Part-time study on a course exceeding 6 months in the UK

A student cannot study a course exceeding 6 months which is designated as part-time using the visitor route unless they are studying at a UK institution by distance learning.

Students wishing to undertake a part-time course at a UK higher education institution of Regulation Qualifications Framework (RQF) level 7 (Scottish Credit Qualifications Framework (SCQF) Level 11) or higher may do so through the Student route.

Accredited institutions

A visitor who intends to study, other than recreational study of up to 30 days, must be accepted on a course of study provided by an accredited institution.

An accredited institution is one that falls into one of the following categories. It must:

- be a licenced student sponsor listed on the [student sponsor register](#)
- hold valid accreditation from:
 - [Accreditation UK](#)
 - [the British Accreditation Council \(BAC\)](#)
 - [the Accreditation Service for International Colleges \(ASIC\)](#)
- hold a valid and satisfactory full institutional inspection, review, or audit by one of the following bodies:
 - [Estyn](#)
 - [Quality Assurance Agency for Higher Education](#)
 - [Education Scotland](#)
 - [Office for Students \(OfS\)](#)

- [the Independent Schools Inspectorate](#)
- [Ofsted](#)
- [the Education and Training Inspectorate Northern Ireland](#)
- be an overseas higher education institution which offers only part of its programmes in the UK

To check that an overseas higher education institution offers programmes equivalent to UK degrees, you should check the [Ecctis](#) website.

Long-term visit visa holders

A visitor who holds a long-term, multiple entry visit visa may wish occasionally to come to the UK to study for up to 6 months. This can include, but is not limited to, people who are pursuing a course of study overseas, including a UK course by distance learning, who are required to study in the UK as part of this.

It may be apparent that the visitor is making repeat visits to complete a longer course of study (they may have confirmation of acceptance on such a course). Such study, if it is not a distance learning course, should be carried out under the Student or Child Student routes. A visitor must not intend to study in the UK for extended periods through frequent or successive visits to complete a course of study of more than 6 months.

If you identify someone making repeat visits in order to complete a longer course of study using a long validity visit visa it may be appropriate to consider cancelling it under Part Suitability [Immigration Rules](#).

State education: children of visiting academics in UK for 12 months

The requirement that a visitor must not intend to study at a state funded school or academy may be waived in the case of a person who is accompanying their parent who is a visiting academic, undertaking research for up to 12 months in the UK.

Admission to state funded schools or academies is not an immigration matter. The Department for Education has policy responsibility for admissions to schools in England. Admissions policy elsewhere in the UK is a matter for the devolved administrations of Scotland, Wales, and Northern Ireland. Responsibility for deciding whether to admit a child to a school, rests with the school's admission authority, which is the local authority in the case of a community or voluntary controlled school, and the school's governing body in the case of voluntary aided or foundation school.

For further information see: [Department for Education \(DfE\): School applications for foreign national children and children resident outside England](#).

Transiting the UK as a Standard or Marriage / Civil Partnership visitor

See: paragraph PA 18 of [Appendix Visitor: Permitted Activities](#) and V 14.1 to V 14.2 of [Appendix V: Visitor](#).

A Transit visitor is a person seeking to travel through the UK on their way to another destination country outside the Common Travel Area (UK, Ireland, the Channel Islands and Isle of Man).

There are 4 ways an individual can transit the UK. These are explained in detail in the Transit guidance.

A person who holds a Transit, Standard or Marriage / Civil Partnership visit visa or permission can use that to enter the UK to transit the UK landside (that is, to cross UK border control while transiting and enter the UK for a maximum of 48 hours). The differences are that a person who holds a Transit visit visa or permission cannot use that to enter the UK for any other reason, they can only transit the UK.

A person who holds a Standard or Marriage / Civil Partnership visit visa or permission can transit the UK as well as undertake any of the other permitted activities in [Appendix Visitor: Permitted Activities](#), with the exception of permitted study under paragraph PA 17, which can only be undertaken by Standard visitors.

For example: a visitor who holds a long-term Standard visit visa valid for 10 years can come to the UK to transit using that visa, without the need to obtain a separate Transit visit visa. Or a visitor who holds a Marriage / Civil Partnership visit visa valid for 6 months can come to the UK to get married or form a civil partnership, leave the UK to honeymoon in a third country and transit the UK on their way to returning to their home country using the same visa.

Full details of considerations and processes can be found in the [transit guidance](#).

Standard visitors intending to transit must meet the requirements under paragraphs V 4.1 to V 4.6 and V 14.1.

Marriage / Civil Partnership visitors intending to transit must meet the requirements under paragraphs V 4.1 to V 4.6, V 14.1 and V 12.1 to V 12.2.

If you are solely a transit passenger and are applying for a Visitor in Transit visa or are seeking permission to enter solely as a transit passenger, then you must satisfy the decision maker that you meet the additional requirements of V 14.2

Related content

[Contents](#)

Visit: period of stay granted

This section gives information on what length and type of entry should be granted in different circumstances.

Long-term visit visas (multiple entry)

Applicants for a Standard visit visa may apply for a visa that allows multiple visits of up to 6 months at a time over a period of:

- 2 years
- 5 years
- 10 years

You can issue a shorter duration visa if the applicant meets the Visitor rules relevant to their visit, but you have concerns about issuing a long-term visit visa. Entry Clearance officers must obtain the authority of the Entry Clearance Manager before issuing a visit visa of shorter duration than that applied for.

You must provide clear reasons for the decision to grant a visa for a shorter period than that applied for in a covering letter when the passport is returned.

In such cases no refund (full or partial) is available.

See: [Frequent or successive visits: how to assess if an applicant is making the UK their main home or place of work.](#)

Extensions for long-term multiple-entry visit visas

If a visitor holds a long-term multiple-entry visa and they want to stay for longer than the visa expiry date, it is possible for them to apply to extend their permission for up to the maximum 6 months permitted for Standard visitors. for example: a visitor arrives in January and their long-term visit visa is due to expire in February. Provided the visitor meets the rules, they can extend for up to 6 months, until June, as a Standard visitor. A single entry or 6-month visa can also be extended to complete 6 months in the UK as a visitor. Applications must be made before the original permission expires.

Single entry visit visa: when and how to grant

Most visit visas allow the person to enter the UK multiple times during its period of validity (except for Approved Destination Status (ADS) Agreement visas).

For other visitors, you must only issue a single-entry visit visa in certain cases, such as:

- children whose visit is sponsored by charities

- in residual doubt cases where the applicant meets the rules, but you have a residual doubt and there is a clearly established, verifiable and compelling reason to visit the UK (see examples below)

A non-exhaustive list of examples of where it may be appropriate to issue a single-entry visit visa includes:

- a key witness (non-expert) at a criminal, civil or family court appearance
- a visit at the request of the police or other agency to assist enquiries
- to attend the funeral of an immediate family member
- to attend a specific one-off genuine event the applicant has been invited to, for example a religious convention
- to conduct a specific business transaction in the UK where the person's attendance is essential
- to visit an immediate family member who is pregnant or who is seriously ill

Entry Clearance Officers must obtain the authority of an Entry Clearance Manager before issuing a single-entry visit visa (except for ADS visas).

Short duration visa: when and how to grant

Unless there are grounds for not issuing a multi-entry or long-term visit visa, you should issue the visa applied for.

You can limit the duration of a visa:

- for children, who should only be granted a long-term visa which is valid to 6 months past their 18th birthday, for example for a 14-year-old applying for a 5 or 10 year long term visit visa, the visa expiry date should be limited to the date that is 6 months after the applicant's 18th birthday
- when it is appropriate to issue a [single entry visa](#)
- when the applicant holds a travel document:
 - with permission to enter another country that must be exercised before a given date
 - that restricts how long they may be outside their country of normal residence

See [Recording requirements for UKVI: granting a short duration visa](#) for information you must record.

Related content

[Contents](#)

[Frequent or successive visits: how to assess if an applicant is making the UK their main home](#)

Visit: suitability

This section gives information on how the suitability rules apply to all visitors.

Part Suitability

Where an application falls to be refused on suitability grounds, or a visit visa or permission to enter or stay as a visitor falls to be cancelled it must be done with reference to the relevant paragraph of Part Suitability [Immigration rules](#)

See also the Grounds for refusal and cancellation (suitability) guidance for further information.

Change of circumstances and cancellation

Under Part [Suitability Immigration rules](#) visit visas and permission to enter or stay as a visitor can be cancelled in specified circumstances.

It is reasonable to expect that a person who is applying for a visit visa or permission to enter or stay will have and be able to articulate a main purpose or purposes for visiting the UK. However, since a visitor can undertake any permitted activity or permitted paid engagement, it is not sufficient reason to cancel a visit visa on arrival due to a change in the declared permitted activity to be undertaken, provided the visitor meets any relevant eligibility criteria for the activity, and does not propose to undertake a prohibited activity.

The primary purpose of a long-term multiple entry visit visa holder is particularly likely to change over the course of 2, 5 or 10 years. It is also possible that a visitor, having indicated on a visa application that they intended to undertake a particular permitted activity, changes their main purpose for visiting before or on arrival at the border. For instance, they proposed to take part in a sporting event that is subsequently cancelled, and they come here for a holiday instead. Since a visitor can undertake any permitted activity or permitted paid engagement, this is permissible.

See Grounds for refusal and cancellation (suitability) guidance for full information about how to consider and apply the Part Suitability rules to visitors.

Related content

[Contents](#)

Grounds for refusal and cancellation (suitability)

Document verification

Related external links

[Curtailment](#)

[Revocation](#)

Visit: children

This section gives information on how to deal with applications from children visiting the UK.

Child welfare duty

See: paragraphs V 5.1 to V 5.2 and V 1.5 of [Appendix V: Visitor](#).

The Home Office has a statutory duty to have regard to the need to safeguard and promote the welfare of children in the UK under section 55 of the Borders, Citizenship and Immigration Act 2009. For more information, see Safeguard and promote child welfare.

You must make sure a child's welfare is taken into account when considering an application from someone under the age of 18.

Child not travelling or residing with their parent or guardian

See: paragraphs V 5.1 to V 5.2 and V 1.5 of [Appendix V: Visitor](#).

Where a child is not travelling or residing in the UK with their parent or guardian, you must be satisfied that travel, care and reception arrangements are adequate and that the requirement for parental consent has been met.

See [recording requirements for UKVI: child not travelling or residing with their parent or guardian](#) for information you must record.

If details are missing, unclear or other factors raise concerns about the child's welfare, you must make further enquiries to confirm the identity and residence of the host and make sure the child is expected.

If you are not satisfied that there are adequate arrangements for the child's welfare in the UK, you may decide to refuse the application.

At the border

If you have any concerns about a child's welfare you must contact your local authority children's services department or the police where appropriate.

Children's Services will advise on the suitability of the sponsor and will take the child into their care, if they agree that the sponsor is unsuitable or if there is no responsible sponsor. See: Border Force children's guidance.

Visit visa applications: parental consent and responsibility for care in home country

See: paragraph V 5.2 of [Appendix V: Visitor](#).

If a parent or guardian is making the application on behalf of the child, this will usually satisfy the requirement for parental consent.

If the applicant's parents are divorced, the consent must come from the parent or parents who hold legal custody or joint responsibility.

If the child is not intending to travel with a parent or guardian, and there are no factors which give cause for concern, a letter from the parent or guardian confirming their relationship to the child and consenting to the child's application will be sufficient to establish that this requirement has been met. This does not preclude you from asking for further evidence if required.

If the applicant provides information that the parent they will be travelling with is not the parent who holds legal custody you should seek consent from both parents.

If there is evidence that the legal authorities (meaning the police or judiciary, not a legal representative of one parent) in the child's country of residence have indicated that they are at risk of being moved out of the country without consent you should seek consent from both parents.

You should also request consent from both parents where you are concerned that the child may be at risk.

If there is no consent from the parent or guardian to support the application and no reasonable explanation why this is the case, the application must be refused.

If an application is made by someone other than the parent or guardian, unless that person is a social worker who holds parental rights and cares for the child, you must make enquiries about the identities of accompanying adults and the person giving consent.

See [Recording requirements for UKVI: parental consent and responsibility for care in home country](#) for information you must record about accompanying adults.

If you have any concerns relating to child trafficking you must consult the victims of modern slavery guidance.

Border Force: parental consent

If there is no parental consent, refer to the Border Force children's guidance.

Private foster care

See: paragraphs V 5.1 to V 5.2 and V 1.5 of [Appendix V: Visitor](#).

A child is considered to be in private foster care when they are:

- under 16 years old, or under 18 years old for those who have a disability
- being cared for on a full-time basis for more than 28 days
- not being cared for by parents, legal guardians or close relatives

This is unless the child is part of a group travelling and staying together and accompanied by an adult, for example: a school group.

If a foster carer or relative who is not a parent or guardian will have responsibility for the child's care whilst in the UK, the applicant must be able to show the following to satisfy you that reception and care arrangements are adequate:

- a written statement of consent from the parent or guardian
- the name and date of birth of the intended foster carer
- the address where the applicant will be living
- the relationship of the foster carer to the applicant
- authority from the parents or legal guardian allowing the foster carer to care for the applicant during their stay in the UK
- where the child is on an educational exchange visit that lasts longer than 28 days and they are not accompanied by their parent or guardian, a letter from the school to include details of the foster care arrangements
- confirmation that the parents have notified, or will notify, the relevant UK local authority, including the reply from the local authority if they have one

You must make every reasonable effort to make sure the documents presented are genuine.

In England and Wales

Private foster care arrangements must be notified to the relevant local authority by:

- the parents or other carer of the child
- other parties to the arrangement, for example the education provider
- the Home Office, if it has not already been done

In Scotland

The regulations require that parents including a guardian or relative:

- notify the local authority of arrangements to be made for the fostering of their children privately under the Foster Children (Scotland) Act 1984
- make provision for the local authority to investigate the suitability of such private fostering arrangements in the interests of the child (regulations 4 to 6) and for the visiting of such foster children by the local authority (regulation 7)

In Northern Ireland

The regulations are equivalent to those in England. Health and social care trusts must be notified of private foster care arrangements lasting more than 28 days in relation to children under 16 years old (or under 18 if they have a disability).

Where a child's visit exceeds 28 days, under private foster care arrangements the host family must present evidence to satisfy you that they have contacted their local Social Services for a home assessment. Where a home assessment has been completed and approved, evidence of this must be provided.

Where a council declines to carry out such an assessment, their response and any relevant evidence to demonstrate that suitable arrangements have been made for the child's stay in the UK must be provided by the applicant.

Child visiting to stay with a host family

See: paragraphs V 5.1 to V 5.2 and V 1.5 of [Appendix V: Visitor](#).

If care arrangements are not adequate the application should be refused.

The checks you must make will vary and depend on whether the child is accompanied or unaccompanied. In all cases a clear record of who is responsible for the child's welfare in their home country and whilst in the UK is imperative.

For host families you need to establish the identity and address of the hosts and you must make sure that the care arrangements meet paragraph V 5.1. In routine cases this could mean seeing a letter from the host family.

See [Recording requirements for UKVI: child visiting to stay with a host family](#) for information you must record about care arrangements.

At the border

Where a child does not present any documentary evidence about the care arrangements, you must pursue enquiries as you see fit to satisfy yourself that the child is not at risk. See:

- Border Force children's guidance
- [Child not travelling or residing with their parent or guardian](#)

Child visit organised by a charity

See: paragraphs V 5.1 to V 5.2 and V 1.5 of [Appendix V: Visitor](#).

Charities must complete the registration form for facilitating child visits to UK host families and provide the following information where they are involved in organising a child's visit to the UK:

- full details of the hosts allocated to accommodate the children whilst in the UK
- full details of checks carried out on the hosts - these checks must be in line with the charity's own child protection policy and any Charities Commission or Devolved Authority requirements, such as Disclosure and Barring Service (DBS) checks
- they must state whether this is the first or a subsequent visit sponsored by the charity for the child

You must be satisfied that appropriate checks have already been carried out by the charity. At the time of application any DBS checks must be no more than 3 years old.

Charities should notify UKVI of any amendments to their registration details, which should be recorded accordingly. It is recommended that charities re-register and provide up-to-date details every 12 months.

Charities may only change the host families allocated to children, that have been stated on the visa application form, in exceptional circumstances. Full details of the new host family and the checks carried out on them must be presented (as set out above). Where Border Force officers have reason to believe that host families have changed, for example if an adult accompanying the child is not one recorded on their visa, they should check the record on the case - working system or check with the visa application centre to confirm whether they have been notified of this change. If not, the officer must be satisfied that the relevant checks on the new host family have been made. If they have not, and the officer is not satisfied that adequate care arrangements are in place, the application should be refused.

Where children are not residing with host families (for example in cases where they may be residing in residential centres), charities must provide full details of the arrangements.

Where the stay will be for longer than 28 days, see: [private foster care guidance](#).

See: Border Force children's guidance.

Accompanied children (visa nationals)

See: paragraph V 1.5 of [Appendix V: Visitor](#).

Issuing an accompanied visa to a child

If the child is travelling with one adult, you must include the adult's passport number, initial and surname on the child's vignette.

If the child intends to travel with two adults one after another during the validity of the visa (for example: the child may arrive with one parent and then travel for a day trip to France with the other), each of the adult's passport numbers must be entered on the vignette. The passport numbers are sufficient as there is not enough space on the vignette to allow for the names of two people as well as the passport numbers.

The endorsement must read 'only valid if acc. by [passport number of first adult], or [passport number of second adult].

See Visit endorsement guidance for the information you must include on the vignette.

Accompanied children at the border

If the child is not travelling with the adult identified on their visa, they may be refused.

If you have concerns over the identity of the accompanying adult, you must:

- check the passport number, initial and surname in the passport of the accompanying adult against the details recorded for the child's visa on the case - working system
- advise the visa application centre that issued the visa so they may make a note against the record, in case subsequent applications are made by the same person

In cases where the accompanying adult has travelled with the child but remains airside and does not accompany the child into the UK, the terms of the visa will not be met. Further enquiries must be made of the child and of the accompanying adult, if the latter can be found. In such cases it may be appropriate to refuse the child entry.

If the accompanying adult has legitimately obtained a replacement passport since the issue of the child's visa, the old, cancelled, passport is acceptable as evidence of identity to allow the child's entry.

If the original passport has been retained by the issuing authority, the new passport is acceptable if it:

- gives the original passport number in full
- contains an official endorsement confirming it replaces the previous passport

Photocopies of the original passport are not, on their own, reliable evidence of identity.

Unaccompanied children

See: paragraph V 1.5 of [Appendix V: Visitor](#).

You must pay particular attention to the circumstances of a child applying to come to the UK on their own.

A child with a visit visa that has been endorsed to say that they are unaccompanied may travel with or without an accompanying adult. for example: they may have obtained a multi-entry visa and be unable to advise in advance who they will travel with on subsequent trips to the UK.

Related content

[Contents](#)

Visit: Medical treatment for visitors

This section gives information on dealing with applications for medical treatment as a visitor.

See: paragraphs V 4.4 (c), V 7.1 to V 7.3 and V 8.1 to V 8.4 of [Appendix V: Visitor](#), and paragraphs PA 16.1 and PA 16.2 of [Appendix Visitor: Permitted Activities](#).

Visitors are not eligible for free of charge treatment on the National Health Service (NHS), unless an exemption from charge applies in law, and therefore may be billed for any NHS treatment received in the UK. Further details are in [the Department of Health and Social Care guidance on overseas visitors](#).

Visitors can access treatment in the UK if it is paid private medical treatment.

Reciprocal healthcare agreement

The UK has reciprocal healthcare agreements (RHCAAs) with a number of countries. RHCAAs generally provide equivalent access to immediately necessary healthcare for the citizens of the contracting countries, where they are present in the other's country for a limited period. Treatment is provided on the same terms as for a local resident (free of charge in the UK). The majority of these RHCAAs apply only to short-term visitors. RHCAAs cater for treatment that arises during a migrant's stay.

The requirement that a migrant should not come to the UK specifically for the purpose of receiving medical treatment does not apply to those coming to the UK to receive planned medical treatment under the RHCAAs with Ireland and the EU (Article SSC.18 of the [Trade and Cooperation Agreement](#)). Free NHS treatment received under these agreements is reimbursed by the health authorities in Ireland or the relevant EU Member State and will be considered as Private Medical Treatment for the purposes of the Visitor rules.

People who are coming to receive planned treatment under an RHCA must have an authorisation form from their government setting out the condition which is to be treated and the planned duration of that treatment.

Assessing a visit for private medical treatment

See: paragraphs V 7.1 to V 7.3 of [Appendix V: Visitor](#).

A visitor wishing to come to the UK for private medical treatment may not be able to present specific documentary evidence for the proposed treatment. But they must provide a letter from their doctor or consultant in the UK detailing:

- their medical condition requiring consultation or treatment
- costs likely to be incurred
- the likely duration of any treatment (which must be finite)

- where the consultation or treatment will take place

A visitor coming to the UK for private medical treatment will also need to be able to show they have sufficient funds to cover all reasonable costs in relation to their visit and treatment.

If you need to make checks on the evidence, you can search the General Medical Council (GMC) [list of registered medical practitioners](#). Or you can contact them using their telephone enquiry service on 0161 923 6602.

If you cannot find the consultant listed in the register, you must make enquiries with the hospital where the consultation or treatment is due to take place to confirm whether the consultant carries out work there.

You must contact the consultant or hospital in the UK if you have doubts about the costs or arrangements for private treatment given to you by the applicant.

There is nothing to prevent a visitor from undertaking private medical treatment once they are in the UK, however if this is their main reason for visiting, they will need to provide this information when they are seeking entry or applying for a visa.

If you receive an application from an individual wanting to take part in a clinical trial in the UK, you should contact Visitor Route Policy for further advice.

See: [Medical treatment for visitors – prohibited medical treatment](#).

Length of treatment

See: paragraphs V 7.2 and V 7.3 of [Appendix V: Visitor](#).

A long period of treatment, for example 11 months, may be acceptable provided there is a clear need for the patient to be in the UK to receive treatment and they have enough funds to meet all costs. You must assess how long treatment is likely to take. For example: fertility treatment could go on for some years. If you obtain the applicant's consent, you will be able to get good estimates by contacting the consultant who is due to treat them. Where the treatment is open ended, the application will fall to be refused.

You must make sure that individuals applying for an 11-month visa for private medical treatment have provided medical evidence to support their stay in the UK for this amount of time. Most visitors seeking private medical treatment would be expected to stay for 6 months or less.

Extension of stay for medical treatment: showing funds

Where a visitor is applying for permission to stay for private medical treatment, if the applicant is reliant on funds from abroad (their own or a third party's), you must ask for proof that the funds are transferable, as certain countries operate strict exchange controls. If there is evidence the person is relying on a third party for funding, you

must get fresh confirmation of the third-party sponsor's willingness and ability to meet the cost.

See guidance on [Maintenance and accommodation provided by a third party](#).

Referral to a medical officer: when you must do this

See: paragraphs V 7.1 of [Appendix V: Visitor](#).

If an applicant has a communicable disease, you must refer them to a medical officer where available.

Applications at the border for private medical treatment

See: paragraphs V 7.1 to V 7.3 of [Appendix V: Visitor](#).

If a person says they are receiving, or intend to receive, health or medical treatment in the UK, you must refer them to the port medical inspector. Admission can be refused on the advice of the port medical inspector.

Applicants will need to satisfy you that they meet the suitability and eligibility requirements, including having sufficient funds available and that they meet the additional requirements for private medical treatment.

If an applicant is successful, they may be granted permission to enter as a visitor for no more than 6 months, subject to a condition prohibiting access to public funds, study, and work.

People escorting private medical treatment visitors

A family member, friend or nurse of the visitor should not accompany a visitor solely for the purpose of being an escort. If they wish to visit the UK for any other permitted activity, they are entitled to apply so long as they meet the Visitor rules. There is also no provision in the Visitor rules for those accompanying the visitors who are accessing treatment to apply to extend their stay longer than six months in the UK.

If a person is here in the UK with a visitor who is receiving private medical treatment and wants to stay in the UK for more than 6 months, you should consider whether there are any compelling, compassionate, or exceptional circumstance that would warrant a grant of leave outside of the rules and refer the case to the Referred Casework Unit (RCU).

Organ donors

See: paragraphs V 8.1 to V 8.4 of [Appendix V: Visitor](#).

Organ donors must provide the specified evidence in the Visitor rules to prove they are a donor match or have been identified as a potential donor to an identified recipient in the UK.

You must be satisfied the organ donor has a genetic or close personal relationship with the intended recipient in the UK.

Genetic relationships would be where the donor is a blood relative to the identified recipient in the UK. Close personal relationships would typically include the visitor's spouse, partner, or close friends. It would not extend to relations established via social media campaigns.

You must also be satisfied that the identified recipient is legally in the UK and entitled to receive treatment either on the NHS or in a private hospital.

It is an offence for money to be given for organ donation. Where you suspect payment is being made in return for organ donation, you must refer the case to Immigration Enforcement International.

Individuals donating to patients receiving NHS treatment can be reimbursed for expenses incurred which are directly attributable to being a donor. These can include travel costs and loss of earnings and are usually paid by the NHS after the treatment. You should look for information as to who is funding the visitor's stay in the UK.

Organ donors should not be accompanied by their children unless there is no immediate care arrangement for them in their country of residence and satisfactory arrangements have been made for them in the UK. In assessing any arrangements for the UK, you should ensure that this accounts for any period the donor will be either in hospital or unable to care for the child or children whilst recuperating.

Secondary applications from organ donors

Where a visitor enters as an NHS donor and is assessed to be an unsuitable match or chooses not to donate, either because they are incompatible with their intended recipient, or prefer a better match, they may choose to pursue a paired or pooled donation. This allows them to be matched with another donor and recipient in the same situation in the National Living Donor Sharing Schemes. The donor organs are then swapped. When 2 pairs are involved, it is a paired donation, and where there are more than 2, it is a pooled donation.

Where an individual applies for a visit visa on this basis, their application must be referred to RCU for consideration outside the rules. Individuals applying on this basis must provide the relevant medical letter, detailing the arrangements involved and specifying whether this is a pooled or paired donation. The application must be assessed against the general visitor requirements and the additional organ donor requirements, except for the requirement to have genetic or a pre-existing emotional relationship with the direct recipient (although they should still have a connection with someone in the group who is receiving an organ transplant).

Confirming the details of a doctor in the UK

See: paragraph V 7.1 to V 7.3 of [Appendix V: Visitor](#).

To check if a doctor is registered with the General Medical Council (GMC) a search can be made on the [list of registered medical practitioners](#). This will also show if the doctor is on the Specialist Register (but not which hospital they work at). Where there is doubt, contact the hospital directly to confirm the doctor is a consultant there.

Requesting a report from a doctor (not the medical inspector)

See: paragraphs V 7.1 to V 7.3 of [Appendix V: Visitor](#).

Any doctor or medical adviser, including the patient's own general practitioner, is likely to charge a fee. For this reason, a decision to request a report as part of the consideration of an application must be approved by a manager at least one grade higher than you.

Surrogacy

There is no provision in the rules for a woman to be allowed into the UK for the purpose of being a surrogate mother. Admission for private medical treatment is not appropriate since the applicant would not be suffering from any medical condition.

Any application from a woman to enter the UK to act as a surrogate should normally be refused on the grounds that there is no provision in the rules. Where there are exceptional circumstances, you should refer the case to Referred Casework Unit (RCU).

See: [medical issues guidance](#).

Related content

[Contents](#)

Transfer or refer a case

Related external links

[List of registered medical practitioners](#)

Visit: Approved Destination Status (ADS) Agreement

This section gives information on considering applications under the ADS agreement with China.

ADS visit visas

See: paragraph V 6.1 of [Appendix V: Visitor](#).

The ADS agreement is an agreement between the UK and China allowing Chinese nationals to enter the UK with an approved tour group.

You must use VISIT - ADS Code 3 for a maximum period of 30 days and marked 'single' or 'dual' to indicate the number of entries to the UK for which it is valid.

In most cases the visa for ADS tourists will be valid for one entry to the UK during the period for which the visa is valid. However, in cases where the tour group's itinerary involves onward travel to Europe and then the group plans to re-enter the UK, dual entry visas should be issued.

Related content

[Contents](#)

Visit: marriage and civil partnership

This section gives information on considering applications to visit the UK to marry or enter a civil partnership.

Visa requirement

All visitors, who are not relevant nationals, who intend to enter the UK to marry or enter a civil partnership or give notice of an intention to marry or form a civil partnership, must have a valid Marriage / Civil Partnership visit visa.

You must include the name of the fiancé, fiancée or civil partner on the vignette.

A relevant national is defined in section 62 of the Immigration Act 2014 as:

- a British citizen
- an Irish citizen
- a person with settled status or pre-settled status granted under the EU Settlement Scheme (EUSS)
- a person with a decision pending on an application for EUSS leave submitted before 1 July 2021

Non-visa nationals who have not applied for a Marriage / Civil Partnership visit visa to come to the UK to marry or enter a civil partnership

See: paragraph V 1.1(b) and V 1.3(a) of [Appendix V: Visitor](#).

Non-visa nationals who are seeking entry to visit the UK to marry or enter a civil partnership, or to give notice of an intention to marry or form a civil partnership, who do not hold a Marriage / Civil Partnership visit visa must be refused entry.

Non-legal marriages

Non-visa nationals who are seeking entry to visit the UK to enter a marriage that is not recognised under UK law are **not** required to hold a Marriage / Civil Partnership visit visa. They can seek entry as a Standard visitor. Visa nationals may apply for a Standard visit visa for this purpose.

Changing an existing civil partnership to a marriage

Non-visa nationals who are seeking entry to visit the UK to convert an existing civil partnership to a marriage are **not** required to hold a Marriage / Civil Partnership visit visa. They can seek entry as a Standard visitor. Visa nationals may apply for a Standard visit visa for this purpose. A civil partnership can only be converted to a marriage if it took place under the laws of England and Wales or Scotland.

A visa national will need to present their original civil partnership certificate as evidence that they are in a valid civil partnership. For non-visa nationals arriving at the border, you will need to see the original civil partnership certificate for the person seeking entry to the UK. If you are satisfied that the purpose of the visit is to change a civil partnership to a marriage a visa or permission to enter as a Standard visitor can be granted.

For guidance on how to convert a civil partnership to a marriage see guidance on [Convert a civil partnership to a marriage](#).

Holders of existing visit visas who want to enter the UK to marry or enter a civil partnership

See: paragraph V 1.1 (b) of [Appendix V: Visitor](#).

Visitors who already have a visit visa to enter the UK and who are now seeking entry to marry or enter a civil partnership (other than when changing an existing civil partnership to a marriage) must hold a Marriage / Civil Partnership visit visa specifically for this purpose.

Giving notice of intention to marry or enter a civil partnership

See: paragraphs V 12.1 and V 12.2 of [Appendix V: Visitor](#).

Visitors intending to marry or form a civil partnership in the UK must give notice at a register office before the marriage or civil partnership can take place. In England and Wales notice must be given in person. In Scotland and Northern Ireland notice can be given by post.

For guidance on what someone giving notice of marriage is required to do (including what documents they are required to have with them) see guidance on [Marriages and civil partnerships in the UK](#).

Assessing a visit where the intention is to give notice or to marry or enter a civil partnership

An individual who is coming to the UK to give notice at a register office will need to show that they have made arrangements to do so, for example by providing confirmation (appointment card or email) of a provisional advance booking to give notice.

An individual who is coming to the UK to marry or form a civil partnership will need to provide evidence they have made arrangements for their marriage or civil partnership to take place in the UK. Examples of evidence include confirmation of the church or register office booking, such as email confirmation or a receipt for payment of the marriage / civil partnership venue.

Assessing whether the marriage or civil partnership is a sham

See: paragraph V 12.2 of [Appendix V: Visitor](#) and paragraph SUI 8.1 of Part Suitability [Immigration rules](#)

An individual seeking entry to the UK must not intend to give notice of, or enter, a sham marriage or sham civil partnership.

For visa applications, you should consider the evidence submitted, including the arrangements for the marriage or civil partnership, the couple's relationship, future plans, and living arrangements. You must be satisfied from the evidence provided that the applicant is in a genuine relationship.

If you are satisfied that it is more likely than not that the applicant is, or has been, involved in a sham marriage or sham civil partnership, you should refuse the application under Paragraph SUI 8.1 of Part Suitability [Immigration rules](#)

Your decision must state the reasons why their application was refused on sham marriage grounds, using the standardised wording as detailed in the Sham marriage guidance.

Related content

[Contents](#)

Related external links

[Giving notice of intention to marry or enter a civil partnership](#)

Visit: referrals to other case - working teams

This section gives information on when to refer visit visa applications to other teams.

You must follow the transfer or refer a case guidance.

Where the applicant does not meet the Visitor rules, but there are compassionate and compelling circumstances you must refer to guidance on leave outside the rules (LOTR).

The referrals to the Referred Casework Unit (RCU) should be made on the referral form and should clearly state the justification for granting LOTR and include comprehensive information, documentary evidence and, if relevant, a full medical report. Authority must be obtained and included from an entry clearance manager (ECM) on the referral form.

Related content

[Contents](#)

Transfer or refer a case

Leave outside the rules

Visit: recording requirements and other procedures for visitor cases

This section gives information on the recording requirements for visitor decisions and other procedures.

UKVI: granting a single entry or short duration visa

Where you issue a single-entry visit visa (except approved destination status (ADS), or a visa with less than 6 months validity, it must be referred to an entry clearance manager (ECM) for approval. You should make clear in the case notes that you have been granted ECM approval.

Where an applicant has requested permission for 6 months, but has been issued permission for a shorter period, the entry clearance officer (ECO) must issue a letter clearly explaining the reasons for this. In such cases, no refund (full or partial) is available.

UKVI and Border Force: credibility and intentions – borderline decisions

Where you have residual doubts about whether a person applying is a genuine visitor, you must record full details of the applicant's stated intentions, especially those given verbally, either on the case - working system or in a written account of the interview.

UKVI: MP letter in support of an application

If an MP writes directly to the visa application centre in support of an application, you should send an acknowledgement stating that when the application is assessed, the MP's letter will be taken into account together with all other available evidence.

UKVI: employers using visitors to undertake work or fill a role

Where you have concerns that specific companies in the UK are sending visitors to their offices to undertake work or fill a role, and circumventing the work routes, you must record this in the notes section on the case - working system and refer it to the Sponsor Management team.

UKVI: child not travelling or residing with their parent or guardian

You must enter the following details on the case - working system to record this (if the information does not auto-populate from the application form onto the case - working system):

- name, address and telephone number of the parent or carer in the child's home country
- the name, address and telephone number of the host in the UK
- the name, address and telephone number of any person accompanying the child

UKVI: parental consent and responsibility for care in home country

You must record the following details about accompanying adults:

- names and passport number - this is necessary for the child's visa
- address in the home country
- any address in the UK or abroad
- employment details
- their relationship to the child, their parent or guardian and their host in the UK

UKVI: child visiting to stay with a host family

The details on the case - working system must be updated to show that satisfactory care arrangements are met and to include the name, address and telephone number of the intended family or carer, as well as the parent's contact details.

Failure to make sure this information is readily available may result in a lengthy delay for the child at the border.

UKVI: requesting a report from a doctor (not the medical inspector)

If you require a doctor's report, you must:

- make a note in the file explaining why the medical report is necessary and refer the proposal to a senior caseworker or an entry clearance manager for approval before any further action is taken
- send or hand to the person (or in the case of a child, the guardian), form ICD 0867 seeking their consent for a medical report to be prepared by their doctor
- on receipt of the patient's consent, write to the doctor asking for a full report and enclose ICD 0868

Forms ICD 0867 and ICD 0868 can be found on the case - working system.

UKVI: extension of stay where a person is receiving NHS medical treatment

If a person is refused (except for where the applicant is an NHS debtor), the refusal notice must be accompanied by a letter making it clear to the applicant they can make a fresh application if they are prepared to have the treatment privately.

Related content

[Contents](#)

Student visa

Printable version

Print this page

1. Overview

You can apply for a Student visa to study in the UK if you're 16 or over and you:

- have been offered a place on [a course by a licensed student sponsor](#)
- have enough [money to support yourself and pay for your course](#) - the amount will vary depending on your circumstances
- can [speak, read, write and understand English](#)
- have consent from your parents if you're 16 or 17 - you'll need evidence of this when you apply

If you're 16 or 17 and you want to study at an independent school in the UK, you may be eligible for a [Child Student visa](#) instead.

This visa has replaced the Tier 4 (General) student visa.

When to apply

When you can apply depends on whether you're applying from inside or outside the UK.

Applying from outside the UK

The earliest you can apply for a visa is 6 months before you start your course.

Applying from inside the UK

The earliest you can apply is 3 months before your course starts.

You must apply before your current visa expires. Your new course must begin within 28 days of your current visa expiring.

How long it takes to get a decision

You'll usually get a decision on your visa within:

- 3 weeks, if you're outside the UK
- 8 weeks, if you're inside the UK

You may be able to pay to [get a faster decision](#) - you'll be told if you can when you apply.

How long you can stay

How long you can stay depends on the length of your course and what study you've already completed in the UK.

If you're 18 or over and your course is at degree level, you can usually stay in the UK for up to 5 years. If it's below degree level, you can usually stay in the UK for up to 2 years.

[Read the guidance to find out exactly how long you can stay.](#)

Staying longer in the UK

You may be able to:

- [extend your visa](#) if you're eligible, for example to continue your studies in the UK

- [switch to a Student visa](#) from another visa if you're already in the UK
- [switch to a Graduate visa](#)

A Graduate visa will allow you to stay in the UK after successfully completing your course for:

- 2 years if you apply on or before 31 December 2026
- 18 months if you apply on or after 1 January 2027

It will allow you to stay for 3 years if you completed a PhD or other doctoral qualification.

When you can travel to the UK

You can arrive before your course starts. This can be either:

- up to 1 week before, if your course lasts 6 months or less
- up to 1 month before, if your course lasts more than 6 months

You must not travel to the UK before the start date given on your visa, no matter when your course starts.

Fees

It costs:

- £524 to apply for a Student visa from outside the UK
- £524 to extend or switch to a Student visa from inside the UK

You must pay the visa fee for each person that joins you.

Healthcare surcharge

You'll also have to [pay the healthcare surcharge](#) as part of your application.

How much you pay depends on how long your visa lasts.

Your partner and children

You may be able to [bring your partner and children \('dependants'\)](#).

What you can and cannot do

You can:

- study
- work as a student union sabbatical officer

You may be able to work - how much depends on what you're studying and whether you're working in or out of term-time.

You cannot:

- claim [public funds](#) (benefits) and pensions
- work in certain jobs, for example as a professional sportsperson or sports coach
- be self-employed
- study at an academy or a local authority-funded school (also known as a maintained school)

If your application is successful, you'll be told what you can and cannot do on a Student visa.

2. Your course

You must have an unconditional offer of a place on a course with a [licensed student sponsor](#).

To prove this, your education provider will send you a reference number (called a Confirmation of Acceptance for Studies (CAS)) once they've offered you a place on the course. You need a CAS before you can apply for your visa.

Courses you can study

You can do one of the following courses:

- a full-time course leading to [a qualification that's below degree level \(RQF level 3, 4 or 5\)](#) with at least 15 hours a week of organised daytime study
- a full-time course leading to [a qualification that's degree level or above \(RQF level 6, 7 or 8\)](#)

- a full-time course [at degree level or above \(RQF level 6,7 or 8\)](#) that's equivalent to a UK higher education course and is being delivered as part of a longer course overseas
- a part-time course leading to [a qualification that's above degree level \(RQF level 7 or above\)](#)
- an English language course at level B2 or above in the [Common European Framework of Reference for Languages](#)

You can also apply for this visa if you're taking up a full-time elected position as a Student Union Sabbatical Officer.

You may also need an [Academic Technology Approval Scheme \(ATAS\) certificate](#) if you're studying or researching sensitive topics at [RQF level 7 or above](#).

[The qualification levels are different in Scotland](#).

Your Confirmation of Acceptance for Studies (CAS)

Once they've offered you a place on the course, your education provider will send you a reference number called a Confirmation of Acceptance for Studies.

You must enter this reference number on your visa application.

You must [apply for your visa](#) within 6 months of receiving your CAS.

3. Money you need

You must have enough money to pay for your course and support yourself in the UK. How much money you need depends on your circumstances and what you're applying for.

Course fee

You need enough money to pay for your course for 1 academic year (up to 9 months). The amount you need to pay will be on your Confirmation of Acceptance for Studies (CAS).

If you've been in the UK with a valid visa for at least 12 months, you do not need to prove you have this money for your visa application.

Money to support yourself ('financial requirement')

You'll need to show you have enough money to support yourself - unless you've been in the UK with a valid visa for at least 12 months on the date of your application.

How much money you need depends on where you will be studying. You'll need either:

- £1,529 per month (for up to 9 months) for courses in London
- £1,171 per month (for up to 9 months) for courses outside London

If you're boarding at a residential independent school, you'll need to pay boarding fees instead. The amount you need to pay will be on your CAS.

London means the City of London and the 32 London boroughs.

You'll need to prove you have [extra money for each family member you bring](#) with you.

You must have this money for at least 28 days in a row. The end date of the 28-day period must be within 31 days of the date you apply for your visa.

Example

If you submit your application on 1 January, you'd have to show that the funds were in your bank account for at least the 28-day period ending on 1 December.

If you have a student loan or financial sponsorship, you'll need to provide evidence of this from your loan or sponsorship company.

[Read the guidance on finances for student applications for more information about the money you need](#) and how to prove it.

When you do not need to prove you have money to support yourself

You do not need to prove that you meet the financial requirement if either:

- you've been living in the UK with a visa for at least 12 months prior to the date of your Student visa application
- you're applying as a student union sabbatical officer

If you're from a country listed under the 'differential evidence requirement'

You do not need to prove you have enough money to support yourself if you're a [British national overseas](#) or from one of the following countries or territories:

- Australia
- Austria
- Bahrain
- Barbados
- Belgium
- Botswana
- Brazil
- Brunei
- Bulgaria
- Cambodia
- Canada
- Chile
- China
- Croatia
- Republic of Cyprus
- Czechia
- Denmark
- The Dominican Republic
- Estonia
- Finland
- France
- Germany
- Greece
- Hong Kong
- Hungary
- Iceland
- Indonesia
- Ireland
- Italy
- Japan
- Kazakhstan
- Kuwait
- Latvia
- Liechtenstein
- Lithuania
- Luxembourg
- Macao
- Malaysia
- Malta
- Mauritius
- Mexico
- Netherlands
- New Zealand
- Norway
- Oman

- Peru
- Poland
- Portugal
- Qatar
- Romania
- Serbia
- Singapore
- Slovakia
- Slovenia
- South Korea
- Spain
- Sweden
- Switzerland
- Taiwan
- Thailand
- Tunisia
- United Arab Emirates
- United States of America

However, you might be asked to provide this evidence before you get a decision on your application.

If you do need to provide it, you'll be contacted by UK Visas and Immigration (UKVI) after you've submitted your application.

[Read the guidance on finances for student applications for more information about the money you need](#) and how to prove it.

4. Knowledge of English

You'll usually need to prove your knowledge of the English language when you apply.

Who does not need to prove their knowledge of English

You do not need to prove your knowledge of English if you're from one of the following countries or territories, or you've completed a qualification equivalent to a UK degree in one of them:

- Antigua and Barbuda
- Australia
- the Bahamas
- Barbados
- Belize
- the British overseas territories
- Dominica
- Grenada
- Guyana
- Ireland
- Jamaica
- Malta
- New Zealand
- St Kitts and Nevis
- St Lucia
- St Vincent and the Grenadines
- Trinidad and Tobago
- UK
- USA

You also do not need to prove your knowledge of English if one of the following

applies:

- you're a national of Canada
- you're applying to come to the UK for a study abroad programme as part of a university degree course in the USA
- you proved your level of English in a previous visa application

How to prove your knowledge of English

You can prove it in one of the following ways:

- having a UK school qualification
- having a degree from a UK institution
- having a degree from an institution that was outside the UK and taught in English
- passing an English test from an approved provider

If you have a UK school qualification

You can prove your knowledge of English if you have a qualification from a UK school that you began when you were under 18. You must have one of the following qualifications:

- a GCSE
- an A level
- Scottish National Qualification level 4 or 5
- Scottish Higher or Advanced Higher in English

If you have a degree from a UK institution

You can prove your knowledge of English if you have a degree-level qualification that was both:

- taught in English
- awarded by a UK institution, even if you studied outside the UK

If you have a degree from an institution outside the UK

If your degree was taught in English and was not awarded by a UK institution, you'll need to [apply for an assessment from Ecctis](#).

Ecctis will give you a code to confirm that your qualification is equivalent to a UK bachelor's degree or higher and was taught in English.

Passing an English test

If you do not have any qualifications that prove your knowledge of English, you will need to [pass a Secure English Language Test \(SELT\)](#) from an approved provider. You must prove you can read, write, speak and understand English to a certain level on the [Common European Framework of Reference for Languages \(CEFR\) scale](#).

What you're studying

Level

Degree level or above

Equivalent to CEFR level B2

Below degree level

CEFR level B1

If you're studying with a Higher Education Provider

If you're studying at degree level or above, your Higher Education Provider (HEP) can assess your level of English themselves. This means they may ask you to do a different test.

This must still be equivalent to a CEFR level B2.

5. Documents you'll need to apply

When you apply for your Student visa you must provide:

- a current passport or other valid travel documentation
- a Confirmation of Acceptance for Studies (CAS) from your course provider

You may also need to provide:

- proof you have enough money to support yourself and pay for your course - this will vary depending on your circumstances
- a valid [ATAS certificate](#) if your course and nationality require it
- proof of parental or other legal guardian consent if you're under 18
- proof of your relationship to your parent or guardian if you're under 18
- your [tuberculosis test results](#)
- written consent for your application from your financial sponsor if you've received sponsorship for your course fees and living costs in the last 12 months

You may need to provide additional documents depending on your circumstances. [Read the guidance for the full list of documents you'll need to provide.](#)

If you're under 18

If you're under 18 you'll need written consent from both parents or legal guardians (or one parent if they have sole responsibility).

This must include their consent for:

- your visa application
- your living and care arrangements in the UK
- your travel to the UK

You'll also need to provide a copy of your birth certificate (or another government issued document) that shows the names of your parents.

6. Apply online

You must apply online for a Student visa.

Check which [documents you'll need to apply](#).

Apply outside the UK

As part of your application, you'll need to prove your identity. How you do this depends on where you're from and what type of passport you have.

You'll either:

- use the 'UK Immigration: ID Check' app to scan your identity document - you'll also create or sign into your UK Visas and Immigration (UKVI) account
- have your fingerprints and photo (biometric information) taken at a [visa application centre](#)

You'll be told what you need to do when you apply.

If you do need an appointment:

- you'll need to take your passport with you to the centre (you'll be able to collect it on the day)
- you may have to travel to get to your nearest visa application centre (this could be in another country)

Once you've started your application, you can save your form and complete it later.

How long it takes to get a decision

You'll usually get a decision within 3 weeks.

You may be able to pay to [get a faster decision](#).

Apply inside the UK

You may be able to apply to:

- [extend your Student visa](#)
- [switch to a Student visa](#) from another type of visa

How long it takes to get a decision

You'll usually get a decision within 8 weeks.

You may be able to pay to [get a faster decision](#).

After you apply

You'll be contacted if your application is complex and will take longer, for example

because:

- your supporting documents need to be verified
- you need to attend an interview
- of your personal circumstances (for example if you have a criminal conviction)

If you need to change something in your application after you've sent it [contact UK Visas and Immigration \(UKVI\)](#).

You can ask to [withdraw your application](#) by contacting UKVI. Your fee will only be refunded if UKVI has not started processing your application.

If your application is successful

You'll get an eVisa (a digital record of your identity and immigration status).

Your decision email or letter will tell you how to [get access to your eVisa](#). You'll need to create a UKVI account.

7. Your partner and children

Your partner and children ('dependants') may be able to apply to come to the UK or stay longer in the UK.

You must be one of the following:

- a government-sponsored student starting a course that lasts longer than 6 months
- a full-time student on a [postgraduate level course \(RQF level 7 or above\)](#) that lasts 9 months or longer

If your postgraduate level course starts on or after 1 January 2024, it must be either:

- a PhD or other doctorate (RQF level 8)
- a research-based higher degree

Your dependants

A dependant partner or child is one of the following:

- your husband, wife or civil partner
- your unmarried partner
- your child under 18 years old - including if they were born in the UK during your stay

You'll need to provide evidence of your relationship when you apply, for example:

- a marriage or civil partnership certificate for your partner
- a birth certificate for your child

[Find out what other documents you can use to prove your relationship.](#)

Your child

You'll need to prove that your child is both:

- not married or in a civil partnership
- living with you, unless they're living away from home in full-time education - for example, at boarding school or university

You'll need to provide 2 of the following documents confirming their address:

- a bank statement
- credit card bills
- driving licence
- NHS registration document
- an official letter from their university or college

If your child pays you rent or upkeep, you'll need to give details.

Money they need to support themselves

Your partner and child must each have a certain amount of money available to them.

This is in addition to the money you must have to support yourself.

How much money they need depends on where you will be studying. They must have either:

- £845 a month (for up to 9 months) for courses in London

- £680 a month (for up to 9 months) for courses outside London

If you're applying at the same time as your partner or child (you're applying together as a family), you'll need to prove you have both [money to pay for your course and to support yourself](#) and additional money for each of them.

If your partner or child is applying at a different time to you (they're applying separately) they only need to prove they have money to support themselves.

You (or your partner or child) must have this money for at least 28 consecutive days. The end date of the 28 day period must be within 31 days of the date they apply for their visa.

If you have a student loan or financial sponsorship, you'll need to provide evidence of this from your loan or sponsorship company. If your loan does not cover your partner or child, you'll need to prove you have money to support them instead.

When they do not need to prove they have money to support themselves

Your partner or child does not need to prove they have this money if they've been in the UK with a valid visa for at least 12 months.

[If you and your partner or child are from a country listed under the 'differential evidence requirement'](#) and you're applying at the same time, they do not need to prove they have money to support themselves.

However, they might be asked to provide this evidence before they get a decision on their application.

If they do need to provide it, they'll be contacted by UK Visas and Immigration (UKVI) after they've submitted their application.

Apply outside the UK

Your partner and children must either:

- [apply online as your partner outside the UK](#)
- [apply online as your child outside the UK](#)

They'll need your application number - you get it when you apply. This number is called a Global Web Form (GWF) or a Unique Application Number (UAN). You'll find it on emails and letters from the Home Office about your application.

Proving their identity

As part of their application, your partner and children will need to prove their identity.

They'll either:

- use the 'UK Immigration: ID Check' app to scan their identity document - they'll also create or sign into their UK Visas and Immigration (UKVI) account
- have their fingerprints and photo (biometric information) taken at a visa application centre

They'll be told what they need to do when they apply.

If they need an appointment:

- they'll need to take their passport with them to the visa application centre (they'll be able to collect it on the day)
- they may have to travel to get to their nearest centre (this could be in another country)

They may be able to pay to get their visa faster or use other services depending on which country they're in - check with the visa application centre.

How long they can stay

If their application is successful, their visa will end on the same date as yours.

Apply inside the UK to extend or switch

Your partner or child can apply to extend or switch their visa either:

- at the same time as you [apply to extend](#) or [switch your own visa](#)
- at any time before their current visa expires

This includes children who have turned 18 during your stay.

Your partner or child cannot apply to switch in the UK if they have one of the following visas:

- a visit visa
- a short-term student visa
- a Parent of a Child Student visa
- a seasonal worker visa
- a domestic worker in a private household visa

Fees

Each person will need to pay:

- £524 for the visa
- [the healthcare surcharge](#)

They'll need to have their fingerprints and a photo (biometric information) taken - there's no fee for this.

How to apply

Your partner and child must apply online. They must either:

- [apply online as your partner inside the UK](#)
- [apply online as your child inside the UK](#)

They'll need your application number - you get it when you apply. This number is called a Global Web Form (GWF) or a Unique Application Number (UAN). You'll find it on emails and letters from the Home Office about your application.

As part of their application, they'll need to have their fingerprints and photo (biometric information) taken at a [UK Visa and Citizenship Application Services \(UKVCAS\)](#) service point.

They'll also need to submit their supporting documents. They can:

- upload them into the online service
- have them scanned at their UKVCAS appointment

They must not travel outside of the UK, Ireland, the Channel Islands or the Isle of Man until they get a decision. Their application will be withdrawn if they do.

They may be able to [pay to get a faster decision](#) - they'll be told if they can when they apply.

If their application is successful

They'll get an eVisa (a digital record of their identity and immigration status).

Their decision email or letter will tell them what to do next and how to get access to their eVisa.

They'll need to create a UKVI account to access their eVisa if they do not already have one.

Children born in the UK

If you have a child while you're in the UK, they do not automatically [become a British citizen](#).

You must apply for your child's dependant visa if you want to travel in and out of the UK with them.

The form you fill in depends on whether your child is inside or outside the UK. Your child must either:

- [apply online as your child inside the UK](#)
- [apply online as your child outside the UK](#)

You'll need to provide a full UK birth certificate for each child, showing the names of both parents.

You must apply for their dependant visa before they turn 18 if they want to stay in the UK.

8. Extend your visa

You may be able to extend your Student visa to stay longer and continue your course

or study a new course. This includes if you currently have a Tier 4 (General) student visa.

To extend your visa you must:

- be in the UK on a Student visa or a Tier 4 (General) student visa
- have an [unconditional offer of a place on a course](#) with a licensed student sponsor - shown by your Confirmation of Acceptance for Studies (CAS)
- show that your studies are at a higher academic level than your current course (called the 'academic progress requirement') - there are some exceptions

If you've been in the UK with a valid visa for less than 12 months, you'll need to [prove you have enough money to support yourself in the UK](#).

Your [partner or children](#) will need to apply separately to extend their visa. They can either apply at the same time as you, or at any time before their current visa expires. You can also [switch to a Graduate visa](#). This will allow you to stay in the UK after successfully completing your course for:

- 2 years if you apply on or before 31 December 2026
- 18 months if you apply on or after 1 January 2027

It will allow you to stay for 3 years if you completed a PhD or other doctoral qualification.

Showing academic progress

If you're currently studying in the UK, you'll usually need to show your studies will be at a higher academic level than your current course.

Your new course must be one of the following:

- at a higher academic level than your current course
- at the same level and related to your previous course or career aspirations - it must be degree level or above at a Higher Education Provider (HEP)
- intercalated to a medicine, dentistry or medical science course you started studying under your Student visa (including a Tier 4 (General) student visa)

You do not need to show your studies are at a higher level if you're doing one of the following:

- resitting exams or repeating modules
- applying for the first time to a new institution to complete a course you started at an institution that lost its student sponsorship licence
- applying after working as a student union sabbatical officer to complete a qualification you started studying under your last Student visa (including a Tier 4 (General) student visa)
- completing a PhD or other doctorate that you started studying under your last Student visa (including a Tier 4 (General) student visa)
- continuing your medical, dentistry or medical science degree after completing an intercalated course
- applying to extend your stay to complete your studies because you've done (or want to do) a work placement or study abroad programme

[Read the guidance for more information about when you need to prove your studies are at a higher level.](#)

If you're applying to work in the UK

You can get a CAS if you're applying to work as a student union sabbatical officer.

When to apply

The earliest you can apply is 3 months before your course starts.

You must apply before your current visa expires. Your new course must begin within 28 days of your current visa expiring.

For example, if your visa expires on 1 December, you must apply for a new visa before 1 December. Your new course must begin by 29 December.

You must also apply within 6 months of getting a [Confirmation of Acceptance for Studies \(CAS\)](#).

You can stay in the UK until you get your decision.

If you applied for an [administrative review](#) because your application was refused, you can stay in the UK until you get your review decision.

Fees

For each person, you'll need to pay:

- £524 to extend this visa
- [the healthcare surcharge](#)

You'll need to have your fingerprints and a photo (biometric information) taken - there's no fee for this.

Apply

You must apply online.

As part of your application you'll need to prove your identity. How you do this depends on where you're from and the type of passport or resident permit you have.

You'll either:

- use the 'UK Immigration: ID Check' app to scan your identity document - you'll also create or sign in to your UK Visas and Immigration (UKVI) account
- have your fingerprints and photo (biometric information) taken at a [UK Visa and Citizenship Application Services \(UKVCAS\)](#) service point

You'll be told what you need to do when you apply.

You must not travel outside of the UK, Ireland, the Channel Islands or the Isle of Man until you get a decision. Your application will be withdrawn if you do.

How long it takes to get a decision

A decision will usually be made within 8 weeks.

You may be able to [pay to get a faster decision](#) - you'll be told if you can when you apply.

After you apply

You'll be contacted if your application is complex and will take longer, for example because:

- your supporting documents need to be verified
- you need to attend an interview
- of your personal circumstances (for example if you have a criminal conviction)

If you need to change something in your application after you've sent it [contact UK Visas and Immigration \(UKVI\)](#).

You can ask to [withdraw your application](#) by contacting UKVI. Your fee will only be refunded if UKVI has not started processing your application.

If your application is successful

You'll get an eVisa (a digital record of your identity and immigration status).

Your decision email or letter will tell you how to [get access to your eVisa](#). You'll need to create a UKVI account.

9. Switch to this visa

You may be able to switch to a Student visa if you already have permission to be in the UK.

You cannot switch to this visa if you have one of the following visas:

- a visit visa
- a short-term student visa
- a Parent of a Child Student visa
- a seasonal worker visa
- a domestic worker in a private household visa
- leave outside the immigration rules

If you have settled or pre-settled status under the EU Settlement Scheme, you do not need to apply for a visa.

Eligibility

To switch to a Student visa you must:

- be in the UK
- have an [unconditional offer of a place on a course](#) with a licensed student sponsor - shown by your Confirmation of Acceptance for Studies (CAS)

If you've been in the UK with a valid visa for less than 12 months, you'll need to [prove you have enough money to support yourself in the UK](#).

Your [partner or children](#) will need to apply separately to switch their visa. They can either apply at the same time as you, or at any time before their current visa expires.

When to apply

The earliest you can apply is 3 months before your course starts.

You must apply before your current visa expires. Your new course must begin within 28 days of your current visa expiring.

For example, if your visa expires on 1 December, you must apply for a new visa before 1 December. Your new course must begin by 29 December.

You must also apply within 6 months of getting a [Confirmation of Acceptance for Studies \(CAS\)](#).

You can stay in the UK until you get your decision.

If you applied for an [administrative review](#) because your application was refused, you can stay in the UK until you get your review decision.

Fees

For each person, you'll need to pay:

- £524 to switch to this visa
- [the healthcare surcharge](#)

You'll need to have your fingerprints and a photo (biometric information) taken - there's no fee for this.

Apply

You must apply online.

As part of your application you'll need to prove your identity.

How you do this depends on where you're from and the type of passport you have.

You'll either:

- use the 'UK Immigration: ID Check' app to scan your identity document - you'll also create or sign in to your UK Visas and Immigration (UKVI) account
- have your fingerprints and photo (biometric information) taken at a [UK Visa and Citizenship Application Services \(UKVCAS\)](#) service point

You'll be told what you need to do when you apply.

You must not travel outside of the UK, Ireland, the Channel Islands or the Isle of Man until you get a decision. Your application will be withdrawn if you do.

How long it takes to get a decision

A decision will usually be made within 8 weeks.

You may be able to [pay to get a faster decision](#).

After you apply

You'll be contacted if your application is complex and will take longer, for example because:

- your supporting documents need to be verified
- you need to attend an interview
- of your personal circumstances (for example if you have a criminal conviction)

If you need to change something in your application after you've sent it [contact UK Visas and Immigration \(UKVI\)](#).

You can ask to [withdraw your application](#) by contacting UKVI. Your fee will only be refunded if UKVI has not started processing your application.

If your application is successful

You'll get an eVisa (a digital record of your identity and immigration status).

Your decision email or letter will tell you how to [get access to your eVisa](#). You'll need to create a UKVI account.

Child Student visa

Printable version

Print this page

1. Overview

You can apply for a Child Student visa if you're between 4 and 17 years old and you want to study at an independent school in the UK.

You must:

- have an [unconditional offer of a place on a course at an independent school](#)
- have a [suitable place to live in the UK](#)
- be able to show you'll have access to enough [money to support you in the UK and pay for your course](#)
- have the consent of your parent or legal guardian to study and live in the UK - you'll need to [prove this when you apply](#)

If you're 18 or over, apply for a [Student visa](#) instead.

This visa has replaced the Tier 4 (Child) student visa.

When to apply

When you can apply depends on whether you're applying from inside or outside the UK.

Applying from outside the UK

The earliest you can apply for a visa is 6 months before you start your course.

You'll usually get a decision within 3 weeks.

Applying from inside the UK

The earliest you can apply is 3 months before your course starts.

You must apply before your current visa expires. Your new course must begin within 28 days of your current visa expiring.

You'll usually get a decision within 8 weeks.

How long you can stay

How long you can stay depends on your age on the date you apply and the length of your course.

Age when you apply

How long you can stay

Under 16

Course length (up to 6 years) plus 4 months afterwards

16 or 17

Course length (up to 3 years) plus 4 months afterwards

When you can travel to the UK

You can arrive up to 1 month before your course starts, but no earlier than the start date given on your visa.

Staying longer in the UK

You may be able to:

- [extend your visa](#) if you're eligible, for example to continue your studies in the UK
- [switch to a Child Student visa](#) from another visa if you're already in the UK

Fees

It costs:

- £524 to apply for a Child Student visa from outside the UK
- £524 to extend or switch to a Child Student visa from inside the UK

You'll also have to [pay the healthcare surcharge](#) as part of your application.

How much you pay depends on how long your visa lasts.

What you can and cannot do

You can study at an independent school.

If you're 16 or over you can work:

- part-time during term for up to 10 hours per week
- full-time during vacations
- on a work placement as part of your course (but not for more than 50% of your course)

You cannot:

- study at an academy or a local authority-funded school (also known as a maintained school) or further or higher education institution
- get [public funds](#) (benefits)
- take a full-time permanent job or be self-employed
- work as a professional sports person (for example a sports coach) or entertainer
- apply for settlement
- bring family members ('dependants') - if a parent wants to accompany you, they'll need to apply for a [Parent of a Child Student visa](#)

If your application is successful, you'll get a full list of what you can and cannot do with a Child Student visa.

2. Your course

You must have an unconditional offer of a place on a course with a [licensed Child Student sponsor](#).

To prove this, your education provider will send you a reference number (called a Confirmation of Acceptance for Studies (CAS)) once they've offered you a place on the course. You need a CAS before you can apply for your visa.

Courses you can study

You can do a course at an independent school that's taught in line with one of the following:

- the [national curriculum](#)
- the [Regulated Qualifications Framework \(RQF\) at level 3 or below](#)
- [independent school education inspection standards](#)

You can also do a course that's accepted as being at the same academic level by:

- [Office for Standards in Education \(Ofsted\)](#)
- [Education Scotland](#)
- [Estyn \(in Wales\)](#)
- [Education and Training Inspectorate \(in Northern Ireland\)](#)

You can do a short 'pre-sessional' course to prepare you for your main course.

You cannot do a foundation course that will prepare you for direct entry to a higher education institution.

Your Confirmation of Acceptance for Studies (CAS)

Once your education provider has offered you a place on a course, they'll send you a reference number called a Confirmation of Acceptance for Studies (CAS).

You'll need to enter this reference number on your visa application.

Your CAS can cover both the pre-sessional course and your main course of study.

You must [apply for your visa](#) within 6 months of receiving your CAS.

3. Where you'll live

You must have a suitable place to live in the UK. You can live:

- at school - this is known as 'boarding'
- with a foster carer or close relative
- with a parent or legal guardian
- independently, if you're 16 or 17 years old

Boarding at school

You can board at school full-time or part-time.

You must have a suitable place to live when you are not boarding. You can:

- live with your parent or legal guardian, if they have a [Parent of a Child Student visa](#)
- live in the UK with someone who is a British citizen or settled in the UK
- leave the country in school holidays

If you live in the UK with someone who is not your parent, they must be one of the following:

- a foster carer
- a close relative
- a nominated guardian - you can only live with them for up to 27 days in a row

A nominated guardian must be at least 18 years old. They can be nominated by your parent, legal guardian or school.

Living with a foster carer or close relative

A foster carer or close relative must be a British citizen or be settled (have 'indefinite leave to remain') in the UK. They cannot be your parent.

A close relative can be a:

- grandparent
- brother or sister
- step-parent
- aunt or uncle

They must be at least 18 years old.

Living with your parent or legal guardian

Your parent or guardian must have a [Parent of a Child Student visa](#). They can only get this visa if either:

- you're under 12 years old
- you have a brother or sister who is under 12 years old and also has a Child Student visa

4. Money you need

You must have enough money available to you to pay for your course and support you in the UK.

How much money you need depends on where you will live and who will be looking after you.

Boarding part-time or full-time at a school

You must have enough money to pay for your course fees and your boarding fees for one academic year (up to 9 months).

Living full-time with a foster carer or close relative

You must have enough money to pay for your course fees for one academic year (up to 9 months).

Your foster carer or close relative must confirm they have at least £570 per month (for up to 9 months).

Living full-time with your parent or legal guardian

You must have enough money to pay for your course fees for one academic year (up to 9 months).

You'll also need £1,560 per month (for up to 9 months) - this amount is for both you

and your parent.

Your parent will need an extra £625 a month (for up to 9 months) for each additional child they accompany to the UK. The child must be your sibling and must also have a Child Student visa.

If you're 16 or 17 and living independently

You must have enough money to pay for your course fees for one academic year (up to 9 months).

You'll also need either:

- £1,334 per month (for up to 9 months) if you're studying in London
- £1,023 per month (for up to 9 months) if you're studying outside of London

London means the City of London and the 32 London boroughs.

[Read the guidance to find out how much money you need and how to prove it.](#)

You must prove you (or your parent) have the money for at least 28 consecutive days. The end date of the 28-day period must be within 31 days of the date you apply for your visa.

Example

If you submit your application on 1 January 2021, you'd have to show that the funds were in your bank account for at least the 28-day period ending on 1 December.

If you have a student loan or financial sponsorship, you'll need to provide evidence of this from your loan or sponsorship company.

When you do not need to prove you have money to support yourself

You do not need to prove you have money to support yourself if you've had a valid UK visa for at least 12 months immediately prior to the date of your Child Student visa application - you must currently be in the UK.

If you're from a country listed under the 'differential evidence requirement'

You do not need to prove you have enough money to support yourself if you're a [British national overseas](#) or from one of the following countries or territories:

- Australia
- Austria
- Bahrain
- Barbados
- Belgium
- Botswana
- Brazil
- Brunei
- Bulgaria
- Cambodia
- Canada
- Chile
- China
- Croatia
- Republic of Cyprus
- Czechia
- Denmark
- The Dominican Republic
- Estonia
- Finland
- France
- Germany
- Greece
- Hong Kong

- Hungary
- Iceland
- Indonesia
- Ireland
- Italy
- Japan
- Kazakhstan
- Kuwait
- Latvia
- Liechtenstein
- Lithuania
- Luxembourg
- Macao
- Malaysia
- Malta
- Mauritius
- Mexico
- Netherlands
- New Zealand
- Norway
- Oman
- Peru
- Poland
- Portugal
- Qatar
- Romania
- Serbia
- Singapore
- Slovakia
- Slovenia
- South Korea
- Spain
- Sweden
- Switzerland
- Taiwan
- Thailand
- Tunisia
- United Arab Emirates
- United States of America

However, you might be asked to provide this evidence before you get a decision on your application.

If you do need to provide it, you'll be contacted by UK Visas and Immigration (UKVI) after you've submitted your application.

[Read the guidance to find out how much money you need and how to prove it.](#)

5. Documents you'll need to apply

When you apply for your Child Student visa you must provide:

- a current passport or other valid travel documentation
- a Confirmation of Acceptance for Studies (CAS) from your course provider
- written consent from your parent or legal guardian for your study and living arrangements in the UK

If you're planning to live with a foster carer, close relative or nominated guardian then

you must provide a letter from them.

You may also need to provide:

- proof that you have enough money to support yourself and pay for your course - this will vary depending on your circumstances
- proof of your relationship to your parent or legal guardian (for example a birth certificate or other government issued document showing their names)
- evidence of the qualifications you used to get a place on your course - if this was required by your course provider
- your [tuberculosis \(TB\) test results](#)
- written consent for your application from your financial sponsor if you've received sponsorship for your course fees and living costs in the last 12 months

Parental consent

You must have written consent from both parents (or one parent if they have sole responsibility) or legal guardian. This must confirm they consent to your:

- visa application
- travel to the UK
- living arrangements and care in the UK

Their consent must confirm that your living arrangements will be one of the following:

- living with your parent or legal guardian
- at an independent boarding school
- living independently and aged 16 or 17
- living with a foster carer or close relative, who is not your legal guardian

Living with a foster carer or close relative

You must provide a letter from your foster carer or close relative.

They must include in the letter:

- their name, current address and contact details
- the address where you'll both live in the UK, if it's different from their current address
- confirmation that the place you'll live is a private address and not operated as a business
- their relationship with your parent or legal guardian
- confirmation that they agree to care for you
- the names of any other people they look after or have offered to look after
- confirmation that they have [enough money to look after you](#), if you will not board at school
- their signature and the date

Living with a nominated guardian

You must provide a letter from your nominated guardian.

They must include in the letter:

- their name, current address and contact details
- the address where you'll both live in the UK, if it's different from their current address
- confirmation that the place you'll live is a private address and not operated as a business
- their relationship with your parent or guardian
- confirmation that they agree to care for you
- the names of any other people they look after or have offered to look after
- details of anyone who lives with the nominated guardian - their name, date of birth, contact details, National Insurance number and any other addresses they live at

- their signature and the date

If you do not know who your nominated guardian is when you apply

You must provide a letter from a member of staff at the organisation that will arrange your nominated guardian.

Their letter must include:

- their name and contact details
- the name and address of the organisation
- the date the organisation was established
- confirmation that all guardians at the organisation have appropriate background checks

6. Apply

You must apply online for a Child Student visa.

Check which [documents you'll need to apply](#).

Apply outside the UK

As part of your application, you'll need to prove your identity. How you do this depends on where you're from and what type of passport you have.

You'll either:

- use the 'UK Immigration: ID Check' app to scan your identity document - you'll also create or sign into your UK Visas and Immigration (UKVI) account
- have your fingerprints and photo (biometric information) taken at a [visa application centre](#)

You'll be told what you need to do when you apply.

If you do need an appointment:

- you'll need to take your passport with you to the visa application centre (you'll be able to collect it on the day)
- you may have to travel to get to your nearest centre (this could be in another country)

Once you've started your application, you can save your form and complete it later.

How long it takes to get a decision

You'll usually get a decision within 3 weeks.

You may be able to pay to [get a faster decision](#).

Apply inside the UK

You may be able to apply to:

- [extend your Child Student visa](#)
- [switch to a Child Student visa](#) from another type of visa

After you apply

You'll be contacted if your application is complex and will take longer, for example because:

- your supporting documents need to be verified
- you need to attend an interview (if you're 16 or 17)
- of your personal circumstances (for example if you have a criminal conviction)

If you need to change something in your application after you've sent it, [contact UK Visas and Immigration \(UKVI\)](#).

You can ask to [withdraw your application](#) by contacting UKVI. Your fee will only be refunded if UKVI has not started processing your application.

After you get a decision

If your application is successful, you'll get an eVisa (a digital record of your identity and immigration status).

Your decision email or letter will tell you how to [get access to your eVisa](#). You'll need to create a UKVI account.

7. Extend your visa

You may be able to apply to extend your Child Student visa to stay longer in the UK. This includes if you currently have a Tier 4 (Child) student visa.

To extend your visa you must:

- be in the UK on a Child Student visa (or a Tier 4 (Child) student visa)
- have an [unconditional offer of a place on a course with a licensed Child Student sponsor](#) - shown by your Confirmation of Acceptance for Studies (CAS)

If you've been in the UK with a valid visa for less than 12 months, you'll need to [prove you have enough money to support yourself](#).

When to apply

The earliest you can apply is 3 months before your course starts.

You must apply before your current visa expires. Your new course must begin with 28 days of your current visa expiring.

For example, if your visa expires on 1 December, you must apply for a new visa before 1 December. Your new course must begin by 29 December.

You must also apply within 6 months of getting a Confirmation of Acceptance for Studies (CAS).

You can stay in the UK until you get your decision.

If you applied for an [administrative review](#) because your application was refused, you can stay in the UK until you get your review decision.

Fees

You'll need to pay:

- £524 to extend this visa
- [the healthcare surcharge](#)

You'll also need to have your biometric information (fingerprints and a photo) taken - there's no fee for this.

Apply

You must apply online.

As part of your application you'll need to prove your identity.

How you do this depends on where you're from and the type of passport you have.

You'll either:

- give your fingerprints and a photograph (biometric information) at a [UK Visa and Citizenship Application Services \(UKVCAS\)](#) service point
- use the 'UK Immigration: ID Check' app to scan your identity document (you will also create or sign in to your UK Visas and Immigration account)

You'll be told what you need to do when you apply.

Health and Care Worker visa

Contents

1. Overview
2. [Your job](#)
3. [If you'll need to meet different salary requirements](#)
4. [Knowledge of English](#)
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9. [Extend your visa](#)
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11. [Switch to this visa](#)
12. [Taking on additional work](#)

Overview

A Health and Care Worker visa allows medical professionals to come to or stay in the UK to do an eligible job with the NHS, an NHS supplier or in adult social care.

Eligibility

Your job

To qualify for a Health and Care Worker visa, you must:

- be a qualified doctor, nurse, health professional or adult social care professional
- work in an eligible health or social care job
- work for a UK employer that's been approved by the Home Office
- have a 'certificate of sponsorship' from your employer with information about the role you've been offered in the UK
- be paid a minimum salary - how much depends on the type of work you do

[Check if your job is eligible.](#)

You must have a confirmed job offer before you apply for your visa.

Knowledge of English

You must be able to speak, read, write and understand English. You'll usually need to [prove your knowledge of English](#) when you apply.

If you're not eligible for a Health and Care Worker visa

You may be eligible for [another type of visa to work in the UK](#).

How long you can stay

Your visa can last for up to 5 years before you need to extend it. You'll need to apply to extend or update your visa when it expires or if you change jobs or employer.

If you want to stay longer in the UK

You can apply to extend your visa as many times as you like as long as you still meet the eligibility requirements.

After 5 years, you may be able to [apply to settle permanently in the UK](#) (also known as 'indefinite leave to remain'). This gives you the right to live, work and study here for as long as you like, and apply for benefits if you're eligible.

How to apply

You must apply online.

How you apply depends on whether you're:

- [outside the UK](#) and are coming to the UK
- inside the UK and [extending your current visa](#)
- inside the UK and [switching from a different visa](#)

If you want to change your job or employer, you must [apply to update your visa](#).

[Your partner and children](#) may be able to apply to join you or stay in the UK as your 'dependants'.

How long it takes

You can apply for a visa up to 3 months before the day you are due to start work in the UK. This date is listed on your certificate of sponsorship.

As part of your application, you'll need to prove your identity and provide your documents.

You may need to allow extra time if you need an appointment to do this. You'll find out if you need one when you start your application.

Getting a decision

Once you've applied online, proved your identity and provided your documents, you'll usually get a decision on your visa within 3 weeks.

You may be able to pay to [get a faster decision](#).

If your application is successful, your [decision email](#) will tell you what you'll get to prove your immigration status and what you need to do next.

How much it costs

You, your partner or children will each need to:

- pay the application fee
- prove you have enough personal savings

[Check how much money you'll need.](#)

Healthcare surcharge

You - and your partner or children - will not have to pay the healthcare surcharge.

You can start using the NHS for free from the date your visa starts.

You'll still need to pay for some services, such as prescriptions, dental treatment, eye tests and assisted conception.

What you can and cannot do

You can:

- work in an eligible job
- [take on additional work](#) in certain circumstances
- study
- bring [your partner and children](#) with you as your 'dependants', if you meet the eligibility criteria
- travel abroad and return to the UK
- apply to settle permanently in the UK (also known as 'indefinite leave to remain') if you've lived in the UK for 5 years and meet the other eligibility requirements
- do voluntary work

Any voluntary work you do must be unpaid and for one of the following:

- a [registered charity](#)
- a voluntary organisation
- an associated fundraising body (an organisation that raises money for a charity or voluntary organisation)
- a statutory body (a government-appointed body, for example Historic England)

You cannot:

- apply for most benefits ([public funds](#)), or the State Pension
- change jobs or employer unless you update your visa

If your application is successful, you'll get a full list of what you can and cannot do with a Health and Care Worker visa.

Skilled Worker visa

Contents

1. Overview
2. [Your job](#)
3. [When you can be paid less](#)
4. [If you work in healthcare or education](#)
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8. [Apply from outside the UK](#)
9. [Your partner and children](#)
10. [Extend your visa](#)
11. [If you got your first certificate of sponsorship before 4 April 2024](#)
12. [Update your visa if you change job or employer](#)
13. [Switch to this visa](#)
14. [Taking on additional work](#)

Overview

A Skilled Worker visa allows you to come to or stay in the UK to do an eligible job

with an approved employer.

This visa has replaced the Tier 2 (General) work visa.

It also allows you to work in UK waters.

Eligibility

Your job

To qualify for a Skilled Worker visa, you must:

- work for a UK employer that's been approved by the Home Office
- have a 'certificate of sponsorship' (CoS) from your employer with information about the role you've been offered in the UK
- do a job that's on the list of eligible occupations
- be paid a minimum salary - how much depends on the type of work you do and the date you got your CoS

The specific [eligibility depends on your job](#).

You must have a confirmed job offer before you apply for your visa.

Knowledge of English

You must be able to speak, read, write and understand English. You'll usually need to [prove your knowledge of English](#) when you apply.

If you're not eligible for a Skilled Worker visa

You may be eligible for [another type of visa to work in the UK](#).

How long you can stay

Your visa can last for up to 5 years before you need to extend it. You'll need to apply to extend or update your visa when it expires or if you change jobs or employer.

If you want to stay longer in the UK

You can apply to extend your visa as many times as you like as long as you still meet the eligibility requirements.

After 5 years, you may be able to [apply to settle permanently in the UK](#) (also known as 'indefinite leave to remain'). This gives you the right to live, work and study here for as long as you like, and apply for benefits if you're eligible.

How to apply

You must apply online.

How you apply depends on whether you're:

- [outside the UK](#) and are coming to the UK
- inside the UK and [extending your current visa](#)
- inside the UK and [switching from a different visa](#)

If you want to change your job or employer, you must [apply to update your visa](#).

[Your partner and children](#) may be able to apply to join you or stay in the UK as your 'dependants'.

How long it takes

You can apply for a visa up to 3 months before the day you are due to start work in the UK. This date is listed on your certificate of sponsorship.

As part of your application, you'll need to prove your identity and provide your documents.

You may need to allow extra time if you need an appointment to do this. You'll find out if you need one when you start your application.

Getting a decision

Once you've applied online, proved your identity and provided your documents, you'll usually get a decision on your visa within:

- 3 weeks, if you're outside the UK
- 8 weeks, if you're inside the UK

You may be able to [pay to get a faster decision](#) - you'll be told if you can when you apply.

If your application is successful, your [decision email](#) will tell you what you'll get to prove your immigration status and what you need to do next.

How much it costs

You, your partner or children will each need to:

- pay the application fee
- pay the healthcare surcharge for each year of your stay
- prove you have enough personal savings

[Check how much money you'll need.](#)

If you work in public sector healthcare

If you're a doctor or nurse, or you work in health or adult social care, check if you're eligible to apply for the [Health and Care Worker visa](#) instead. It's cheaper to apply for and you do not need to pay the annual immigration health surcharge.

What you can and cannot do

With a Skilled Worker visa you can:

- work in an eligible job
- study
- bring [your partner and children](#) with you as your 'dependants', if you meet the eligibility requirements
- [take on additional work](#) in certain circumstances
- travel abroad and return to the UK
- apply to settle permanently in the UK (also known as 'indefinite leave to remain') if you've lived in the UK for 5 years and meet the other eligibility requirements
- do voluntary work

Any voluntary work you do must be unpaid and for one of the following:

- a [registered charity](#)
- a voluntary organisation
- an associated fundraising body (an organisation that raises money for a charity or voluntary organisation)
- a statutory body (a government-appointed body, for example Historic England)

You cannot:

- apply for most benefits ([public funds](#)), or the State Pension
- change jobs or employer unless you apply to update your visa

If your application is successful, you'll get a full list of what you can and cannot do with a Skilled Worker visa.

Graduate visa

Contents

1. Overview
2. [The course you studied](#)
3. [How much it costs](#)
4. [Documents you'll need to apply](#)
5. [Apply](#)
6. [Your partner and children](#)

Overview

A Graduate visa gives you permission to stay in the UK for at least 18 months after successfully completing an eligible course in the UK.

You must be in the UK when you apply.

Eligibility

You can apply for a Graduate visa if all of the following are true:

- you're in the UK
- your current visa is a [Student visa or Tier 4 \(General\) student visa](#)

- you studied a UK bachelor's degree, postgraduate degree or other eligible course for a minimum period of time with your Student visa or Tier 4 (General) student visa
- your education provider (such as your university or college) has told the Home Office you've successfully completed your course

You can ask your education provider if you're not sure whether they've told the Home Office you've successfully completed your course.

[Check if your course is eligible and how long you need to have studied in the UK.](#)

If you're not eligible for a Graduate visa, you may be eligible for [another type of visa to stay in the UK](#).

How long you can stay

A Graduate visa lasts for:

- 2 years if you apply on or before 31 December 2026
- 18 months if you apply on or after 1 January 2027

If you have a PhD or other doctoral qualification, it will last for 3 years.

Your visa will start from the day your application is approved.

If you want to stay longer in the UK

You cannot extend your Graduate visa. However, you may be able to switch to a different visa, for example a [Skilled Worker visa](#).

Check you can apply for [another type of visa to stay in the UK](#).

How to apply

You must [apply online for a Graduate visa](#).

[Your partner and children](#) can also apply to stay in the UK if they are eligible.

When to apply

You must apply before your Student visa or Tier 4 (General) student visa expires.

You can apply after your education provider (such as your university or college) has told the Home Office that you've successfully completed the course you took with your Student or Tier 4 (General) student visa. You do not have to wait until you've graduated or have been given a certificate.

As part of your application, you'll need to prove your identity and provide your documents.

Your application may take longer if you need an appointment to do this. You'll find out if you need one when you start your application.

Getting a decision

Once you've applied online, proved your identity and provided your documents, you'll usually get a decision on your visa within 8 weeks.

You can stay in the UK while you wait for a decision.

How much it costs

When you apply for a Graduate visa, you'll need to:

- pay the £880 application fee
- pay the healthcare surcharge - this is usually £1,035 for each year you'll be in the UK

[Check how much it will cost.](#)

If you work in public sector healthcare

If you're a doctor or nurse, or you work in health or adult social care, check if you're eligible to apply for the [Health and Care Worker visa](#) instead. It's cheaper to apply for and you do not need to pay the annual immigration health surcharge.

If you get a job in public sector healthcare after you have paid the healthcare surcharge, you may be able to [get a refund](#).

What you can and cannot do

With a Graduate visa you can:

- work in most jobs
- look for work
- be self-employed
- [continue living in the UK with your partner and children](#), if they're eligible
- travel abroad and return to the UK
- do voluntary work

Any voluntary work you do must be unpaid and for one of the following:

- a [registered charity](#)
- a voluntary organisation
- an associated fundraising body (an organisation that raises money for a charity or voluntary organisation)
- a statutory body (a government-appointed body, for example Historic England)

You cannot:

- apply for most benefits ([public funds](#)), or the State Pension
- work as a professional sports person

If your application is successful, you'll get a full list of what you can and cannot do with a Graduate visa.

Studying with a Graduate visa

You can only study with a Graduate visa if your chosen course is [not eligible for a Student visa](#). If your course is eligible for a Student visa, you can [extend your Student visa](#) instead.

You may need an [Academic Technology Approval Scheme \(ATAS\) certificate](#) if you're studying or researching sensitive topics.

Innovator Founder visa

Contents

1. Overview
2. [Eligibility](#)
3. [Knowledge of English](#)
4. [Documents you'll need to apply](#)
5. [Apply from outside the UK](#)
6. [Your partner and children](#)
7. [Extend your visa](#)
8. [Switch to this visa](#)

Overview

You can apply for an Innovator Founder visa if:

- you want to set up and run an innovative business in the UK - it must be something that's different from anything else on the market
- your business or business idea has been endorsed by an approved body, also known as an [endorsing body](#)
- you meet the other [eligibility requirements](#)

This visa used to be called the Innovator visa.

Eligibility

You must be able to show that your business idea is:

- new - you cannot join a business that is already trading
- innovative - you must have an original business idea which is different from anything else on the market
- viable, with potential for growth
- scalable - you must give evidence of planning that includes creating jobs and growing into national and international markets

You'll need to get an [endorsing body](#) to assess that your business idea meets the requirements.

Knowledge of English

You must be able to speak, read, write and understand English. You'll usually need to [prove your knowledge of English](#) when you apply.

If you're not eligible for an Innovator Founder visa

You may be eligible for [another type of visa to work in the UK](#).

How long you can stay

You can stay for 3 years if you either:

- come to the UK on an Innovator Founder visa
- switch to this visa from another visa while in the UK

You'll need to meet with your endorsing body after 12 months and 24 months to show you're making progress with your business. Your visa may be cut short if your endorsement is withdrawn by the endorsing body. If you want to stay longer, you must re-apply with a new endorsement before your current visa expires.

If you want to stay longer in the UK

You can [apply to extend your stay](#) for another 3 years when your visa is due to expire. There's no limit on the number of times you can extend.

You may be able to apply for settlement once you've been in the UK for 3 years.

How to apply

You must apply online.

How you apply depends on whether you're:

- [outside the UK](#) and are coming to the UK
- inside the UK and [extending your current visa](#)
- inside the UK and [switching from a different visa](#)

[Your partner and children](#) can apply to join you or stay in the UK as your 'dependants' if they're eligible.

How long it takes

As part of your application, you'll need to prove your identity and provide your documents.

You may need to allow extra time if you need an appointment to do this. You'll find out if you need one when you start your application.

Getting a decision

Once you've applied online, proved your identity and provided your documents, you'll usually get a decision on your visa within:

- 3 weeks, if you're outside the UK
- 8 weeks, if you're inside the UK

You may be able to pay to [get a faster decision](#).

Fees

How much you pay for an application depends on where you apply from.

It costs £1,274 per person if you apply outside the UK.

It costs £1,590 per person if you apply to extend or switch your visa in the UK.

Endorsement

You'll need to pay £1,000 to get an endorsement from an approved [endorsing body](#).

If your visa application is successful, you'll also have to pay £500 each time you meet with your endorsing body. You need to meet at least twice during your stay in the UK.

You pay these fees directly to your endorsing body.

Healthcare surcharge

You'll also have to [pay the healthcare surcharge](#) as part of your application.

If you're applying to extend or switch in the UK

You'll also need to have your biometric information (fingerprints and a photo) taken - there's no fee for this.

What you can and cannot do

With an Innovator Founder visa you can:

- set up a business or several businesses
- work for your business - this includes being employed as a director, or self-employed as a member of a business partnership
- do work outside your business, as long as it's a job needing at least [a level 3 qualification](#)
- [bring your partner and children with you as your 'dependants'](#), if they're eligible
- travel abroad and return to the UK
- apply to settle permanently in the UK (also known as 'indefinite leave to remain') if you've lived in the UK for 3 years and meet the other eligibility requirements

You cannot:

- apply for most benefits ('[public funds](#)')
- work as a professional sportsperson, for example a sports coach

If your application is successful, you'll get a full list of what you can and cannot do with an Innovator Founder visa.